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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Friday, 7th November, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 3:09 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR
BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, after Prayers, there would be no Roll Call, no Message from His Excellency the President, no Formal Communication from the Speaker.

We will take the item numbered 5, Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I have in my hand the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 6th November, 2025, for your correction.

Page 1...12.

Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, on page 11, the Question numbered 415, in the item listed as (ii) with the word “Ahenema Kokobeng”, there is no letter “g” at the end of the word “Kokobeng”. So, the letter “g” should be deleted. This is a minor observation.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I think what was captured in the Question has the letter “g”. Is the Member who asked the Question present—What is the correct position of the letter?

Mr Kofi Amankwa-Manu: Mr Speaker, “Ahenema Kokobeng”, should have the letter “g” at the end.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Prof Kingsley Nyarko, take note.

Prof Nyarko: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 12...23.

Yes, Hon Nitiwul?

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

It is not a correction, but on the Page numbered 15—In this era of technology, is it not better to get the signature of the Speaker and the Clerk imprinted on this document instead of leaving it like this? Is it not better to change? Since 1992, we have always left it blank. But if I were to take this document and there are these two names there, even though we know it is authentic, one day, somebody may say it is not authentic.

Today, we have digital signatures. So, instead of leaving it blank, they can always imprint it there and it will appear the same way. I am asking whether that is possible.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, it could be possible, but there may be a problem when the Speaker and the Clerk are not around.

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, as long as it is the Speaker and the Clerk who are—they do not need to physically be present to sign. If you want to take the two signatures—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If there is somebody like me who would not want his signature to appear under a document that I have not perused, there will still be that problem.

Mr Nitiwul: What is the value of the names on the document? What is it for?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: When it comes to interpretation, in using a name and a signature, the weight that is attached to a signature is not the same that is attached to just the name.

But this is a matter that we can consider.

[No correction was made to the Votes and Proceedings of Thursday, 6th November, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have two *Official Reports* for 30th October, 2025, and 31st October, 2025, for your quick corrections.

We shall start with the *Official Report* of 30th October, 2025. Hon Members, the *Official Report* is before you for your corrections. Any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Thursday, 30th October, 2025.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now the *Official Report* of 31st October, 2025, is for your correction. Hon Members, any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Friday, 31st October, 2025.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the next item on the *Order Paper* is the item numbered 6, Presentation of the Business Statement for the fourth week.

Chairperson of the Committee, will you please present the Business Statement?

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Chairperson for the Business Committee/Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the Committee met yesterday, Thursday, 6th November, 2025, and arranged Business of the House for the Fourth Week ending Friday, 14th November, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its report as follows:

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Question(s)

respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers to

	<u>No. of Question(s)</u>
i. Minister for Lands and Natural Resources	6
ii. Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment	3
iii. Minister for Roads and Highways	10
iv. Minister for Food and Agriculture	6
v. Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts	<u>3</u>
Total Number of Questions	<u>28</u>

Mr Speaker, in all, five (5) Ministers are expected to attend upon the House to respond to Twenty-Eight (28) Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

- i. Urgent – 1;
- ii. Oral – 27

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Standing Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policies. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Standing Order 159, Bills may be presented

to the House for First Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Pursuant to Order 97 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the Week.

Referrals at Committees

Mr Speaker, attached is the list of pending referrals before the Committees for the attention of the House as part of

effort to remind the respective Committees to expedite work on the referrals and report to the House. A total of Three Hundred (300) referrals has been made to twenty-three (23) Committees for consideration and report to the House.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee urges all Committees to prioritise consideration of the referrals and promptly report to the House in accordance with Order 267 (4) of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Presentation of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government

Mr Speaker, on Thursday, 13th November, 2025, the Minister for Finance on the authority of the President of the Republic, would present to this honourable House the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the year ending 31st December 2026 in accordance with article 179 of the Constitution. The Business Committee, therefore, urges Hon Members to take note and be present in the House on the said date.

Submission of Budget Estimates

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee urges the Ministry of Finance, other Ministries and Independent Constitutional Bodies to submit estimates to the House on time for the consideration and approval.

Post-Budget Workshop

Mr Speaker, in view of the presentation of the Budget Statement and

Economic Policy of Government, a post-budget workshop will be scheduled for the participation of all Members of Parliament. The venue and time will be communicated in due course.

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Standing Order 216 (2) and subject to Order 67 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the Week.

3:19 p.m.

Tuesday, 11th November, 2025

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

Ms Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah (Salaga South): To make a Statement in memory of Her Excellency Nana Konadu Agyemang-Rawlings – Former First Lady of the Republic.

Ms Damata Ama Appianimaa Salam (Afigya Kwabre South): To make a Statement on the Demise of our Former First Lady, Her Excellency Nana Konadu Agyeman –Rawlings.

Ms Mavis Kuukua Bissie (Ahanta West): To make a Statement on the Need to Protect Ghana's Forest Reserves and Develop them into Ecotourism Destinations for Revenue Generation.

Urgent Question

- (a) **Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku (Offinso South):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources what measures the Ministry is taking to combat armed illegal miners who besiege our forest reserves.

Questions

***458. Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources whether cocoa farms or crops have been selected as a preserve of only the Forestry Commission in the REDD+ programme, and the justifications for this.

***546. Mr Akwasi Konadu (Manhyia North):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources what specific measures are being implemented by the Ministry in partnership with the Forestry Commission to safeguard the forest plantations established under the government's flagship Green Ghana Project within the Tano-Offin shelterbelt forest reserve (Nkawie) where parts of the reserve are reportedly at risk due to the activities of illegal miners.

***460. Mr Duke Willam Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources how the Forestry Commission plans to ensure the successful establishment of 12,000 hectares of forest plantations and 500 hectares of reclaimed mined-out sites under the 2025 robust Afforestation and Reforestation (ARR) Programme.

***519. Mr Francis Kwabena Owusu Akyaw (Juaben):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources whether the Ministry has signed licence for the purchase and export of gold since he assumed office.

***545. Mr Issah Salifu Taylor (Tarkwa/Nsuaem):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources how the Ministry is going to support small-scale miners in Tarkwa Nsuaem to transition to sustainable and legally compliant mining practices to promote environmental protection and community development.

***470. Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (Manso Nkwanta):** To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what proactive measures the Ministry is taking on labour upheavals that has become rife lately in the country.

***503. Mr Tweneboah Kodua Fokua (Manso Nkwanta):** To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what the Ministry is using to track employment growth and if these targets area being met.

***504. Mr Tweneboah Kodua Fokua (Manso Nkwanta):** To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what is being done to improve occupational health and safety standards, especially in high-risk industries like construction and mining.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Half Year Audit Committee Report of the Births and Deaths

Registry for the period 1st January to 30th June, 2025.

- (b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nanumba North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (c) Report of the Auditor-General on the technical and Forensic Audit on the Central Service Management Portal (CSMP) and Metric App of the National Service Authority.
- (d) Mining Lease Agreement Between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Barari DV Ghana Limited for the mining of Lithium and other minerals at Mankessim (42.63km²) in the Mfantseman District in the Central Region

Motions

Committee sittings

Wednesday, 12th November, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (Evalua-Ajomoro-Gwira): To make a Statement on the Legacy of Anton Wilhelm Amo – Axim’s Gift to the World.

Mr Solomon Kuyon (Krachi Nchumuru): To make a Statement on

the Urgent Need for a National Youth Development Fund.

Mr Seidu Alhassan Alajor (Chereponi): To make a Statement on the Production of Sesame and Its Economic Benefits to Rural Farmers in Chereponi, North East Region.

Questions

***454. Mr Sanja Nanja (Atebubu/Amantin):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways why the contractor working on the Atebubu-Kwame Danso Road has abandoned site.

***370. Mr Yao Gomado (Akan):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways whether the Ministry has plans to construct a bridge over River Asokorkor to serve Dodo-Bethel and Dodo-Amanfrom.

***474. Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways about the current state of the Kokobra – Okyerekrom – Ekyem – Achiase road in the Ejisu Constituency and when work will resume to complete the road.

***383. Mr Samuel Awuku (Akwapim North):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the road from Larteh Junction to Larteh Township will be completed, as well as the inner roads in the township.

***357. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the government will continue work on the Bekpo-Sukladzi road after construction of culverts since 2008.

***384. Mr Kwame Appiah Kodua (Fanteakwa North):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Begoro township roads will continue after the contractor left the site.

***400. Mr Daniel Dung Mahama (Talensi):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the following roads in the Talensi Constituency will be constructed: (i) Tongo through Yameriga, Sheaga Duuei linking Nabdam District (ii) Tongo through Baare, Tongo Beo linking Bolgatanga East District.

***452. Mr Ralph Poku-Adusei (Bekwai):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways what steps the Ministry is taking to ensure permanent rehabilitation of the Kensere-Pampaso and Dotom-Koniyaw roads in Bekwai Constituency.

***473. Mr Alamzy Billa Nikyema (Chiana-Paga):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the collapsed bridge on the Mavio-Manyoro road will be fixed.

***477. Mr Alamzy Billa Nikyema (Chiana-Paga):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when work on the Chuchuliga Chiana road will resume and be completed.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee sittings

Thursday, 13th November, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

- **Minister for Finance:** To present the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Lottery Authority for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee sittings

Friday, 14th November, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Ms Korkor Laurette Asante (Atiwa West): To make a Statement on Emergency Care in Ghana; A Lack Thereof.

Mr Tetteh Nyarko (Upper Manya Krobo): To make a Statement on the Commemoration of the Annual Ngmayem Festival Celebrated by the Chiefs and People of Manya Kloe Traditional Area, to be Held from 27th October to 1st of November.

Mr Charles Aseidu (Tano South): To make a Statement on the Urgent need to Revitalise the Ghana Cylinder Manufacturing Company Limited.

Questions

***273. Mr Richard Kuuire (Nandom):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture when the Farmers Services Centre at the Nandom Constituency will be established and made operational.

***342. Ms Ida Adjoa Asiedu (Ayensuano):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what training or capacity-building programmes are available for farmers to improve their skills and knowledge on modern farming practices.

***425. Mr Richmond Edem Kofi Kpotosu (Ho Central):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the Ministry's projected number of months for food security in case of global pandemic.

***429. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture how much funds Ghana has received from international organisations to combat drought in northern part of Ghana and how it has been used.

***464. Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (Kwabre East):** To ask the Minister Food and Agriculture the plans of the Ministry to ensure sustainable prices for actors in the Cocoa value chain including farmers, licensed buying companies and transporters.

***529. Mr Anthony Mmieh (Odotobri):** To ask the Minister for

Food and Agriculture what specific measures are currently being implemented to enhance the oil palm industry in Ghana particularly in the processing sector, given that the Minerals Commission has distributed millions of oil palm seedlings since 2019.

***544. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the plans of the Ministry to expand employment to the indigenes in Kakum National Park enclave who have been marginalised from employment opportunities in the Constituency.

***577. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts how the Ministry plans to implements the Black Star experience in 2025 and what institutional partnerships and private sector collaborations are being established to ensure its success as a diaspora tourism brand.

***595. Mr Felix Akwetey Okle (Bortianor Ngleshie Amanfro):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts and the plans of the Ministry to develop the Solo Monkey Forest in Bortianor to expand the tourism industry for economic development and sustainable ecological management.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee sittings

[Find the List in Appendix 1 in Column 133]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Committee, led by the Chairman, has presented the Business Statement, and it is now for your comments.

Yes, Hon Dominic Nitiwul.

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

I noticed from page 2, paragraph 3 of the Business Statement that the Chairman pointed out that there were some referrals to the Committees with the list attached. So, I went to look at the list on pages 1 to 22. I have gone through every one of them, and I want to thank him for this. It is very good, but what is missing is the referral to the Appointments Committee. I thought the Speaker had made some referral to the Appointments Committee.

I have looked at it, and it is not there. I want to find out from him when that exercise will be done. When is the referral going to be taken by the Committee? Because it is as important as any other, if not more important. I am talking about the Chief Justice.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member.

Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah: Mr Speaker, I notice that the Minister for the

Interior spoke at length on the post-election violence report. Mr Speaker, we would want to find out when it will be brought to the House to ascertain the fate of Naa Koryoo and as to why his own colleague threw him under the bus.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, have you taken a look at the Business Statement carefully, which states that a report may be presented? Hon Member, you are pretending as if you have not heard me.

Mr Baffour Awuah: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Alhaji.

Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

For some time now, Members in this House have made complaints to the Majority Leader and Leader of Government Business about the office air conditions. Mr Speaker, till now, we have not seen any action from the Leader. Some of these air conditioners not working has contributed to Members not coming to Parliament. If we come to Parliament and we do not have anywhere to sit before we come to the Chamber, it is difficult. I am pleading to the Leader as a matter of urgency, to look into it so that we see how the air-conditioning will be fixed for Members in the shortest possible time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Prof Kingsley Nyarko.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, thank you for indulging me. This relates to the non-functioning of the air conditioning in our office. We come to Parliament at times early in the morning, and we cannot sit in the office or hold meetings there because the environment is so hot. We are compelled to go to the library. The library opens at nine and closes at five p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, is that not repetitive of what the Hon Member has just said?

Prof Nyarko: No, I am saying that we visit at the library, which starts at nine and closes at five. Because of the inconvenience in our offices, is it possible for the library time to be extended so that instead of 5 p.m., they can close around eight or nine, so that some of us can also go there and study.

Because of the 24-Hour Economy, the library can even be open 24 hours. So, I am just suggesting to my revered Leader that, for the sake of some of us who do not have the luxury of reading in our offices, to make use of the library.

My other issue has to do with the lift, which is not functioning properly and is not helping us. At times, if the lift is not working, those of us on the 11th floor we would have to walk. And looking at the level, it is so troubling.

My last issue has to do with the microphones in the committee rooms. At times, it is also embarrassing that we would be holding meetings, and we

would be struggling to speak into the microphone. So, I think, as a matter of urgency, we should get them fixed. It even affects our image. We have guests and they are not working, and the image out there, Mr Speaker, is not the best. So, I want to put this before the House.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Hon Sanja Nanja.

Mr Sanja Nanja: I want to draw the Business Committee's attention that the Question standing in my name, Question numbered 454, has already been asked on the 29th of last month; it has been repeated here, if they could just expunge it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, Hon Annoh-Dompreh.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

3:29 p.m.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me commend the Leader of the House for the presentation. We have been told that the Hon Minister for Finance is scheduled to be in the House on Thursday. Leadership has a role to play in preparing the House to receive one of our own, the Minister, as the practice of this House. I do not need to elucidate on details. I humbly want to suggest to my good Friend, the Majority Chief Whip and the Leader of the House, I do not think it will be out of place for us to have a Committee of the Whole so that we can engage appropriately before the Minister comes.

Mr Speaker, I have seen 28 Questions advertised and I am old enough in this House to know the average number of Questions that we often take in a typical day. I concede that because of the Budget Statement presentation on Thursday, we have limited number of days to deal with Questions. But, Hon Majority Leader, as of my last check at the Table Office, we have over 320 Questions outstanding. It is worrying. I do not need to belabour the point on the essence of Questions. We know it is a critical at the disposal of Hon Members to elicit response as part of our oversight.

I also looked at a number of the Questions. If we are not careful, we will be going into circumstances where these Questions outlive their usefulness. I want to humbly suggest that if it is possible, we vary the 2:00 p.m. Sitting because in effect we have only Tuesday and Wednesday for the Questions because Thursday will be Budget Statement presentation. If we look at the proposed Business Statement, we have no Questions scheduled for Thursday, and practically, it is something we cannot do. Why do we want to Sit at 2:00 p.m. for the two days?

I think Order 71 (3) of the Standing Orders of Parliament allows the Hon Majority Leader to submit supplementary statements to the adopted Business Statement. The complaint is becoming too much. There are lots of Questions that are not being answered. Even today, the Majority Leader informed us at Conclave that Questions slated for today cannot be answered because the Hon Minister is not

available. That is what he said. Even though he has failed to communicate officially, I would not want to go into that.

But the gravamen of my point is that we must get innovative to get these Questions dispensed of.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But Hon Member, in all fairness, he told us why the Minister cannot be available at Conclave.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I have always been fair. But I am saying that the Minister has not written. At least, that has been the practice. It cannot just be by mere word of mouth.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, what you said is that Hon Majority Leader did not tell you why the Minister is not here. I am saying that in all fairness, he said so, and I have heard him. That is quite different from writing formally.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I would not want to do this with you. What I said was, even though he told us at Conclave, the Minister has not written officially. What I am saying is different from what you are saying.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then in that case, you are right.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Yes, I am right. So, over 300 Questions are still hanging. This is the Parliament of Ghana; we demand answers. About 300 Questions are still hanging in the balance. We are being told that even

those that have been advertised on the *Order Paper*, we are not taking them; Mr Speaker, that is the crux of the matter. It is a big challenge. How will the public see us?

Besides the point, I was nudging the Majority Leader on Businesses that are advertised on the *Order Paper* and they remain there, mute, and we do not take them. For instance, the Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill, we are aware there is an engagement going on that we should not advertise it. The Table should be liaising with the Majority Leader. We cannot be advertising Businesses—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is also not correct because we took a few clauses and we intend finishing the same today. We took a few clauses yesterday and we intend doing the rest of the clauses today.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, fair enough. I will not belabour the point. Hon Majority Leader, I want to plead with you, about 300 Questions is no joke. You can check at the Table Office. *[Interruption]* Mr Dafeamekpor, evidence? Check at the Table Office. Hon Members file these Questions on reasonable grounds and they demand Answers. All we hear is that the Minister is not here, or is not available and these Questions are still pending. I plead.

When the Budget Statement is presented, this is the cycle: we go for post-Budget Workshop; when we come back, we are going to start taking Motions. The Motions will be taken all the days. Hence, these Questions will

suffer. When are we going to take these 320 Questions?

The Hon Majority Leader is a fine gentleman, but the way he sometimes trivialises some of these things as Questions, we on this Side cannot compromise.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, but as a member of the Business Committee, having regard to the volume of the Questions, you can suggest it at the Business Committee to increase the number of Questions that are supposed to be taken a day?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am happy you made this suggestion. That also brings another matter in its wake.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, but you are part of the Business Committee. You are supposed to know about the document being presented by the Chairman of the Committee.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the records will reflect that I have been on leave. I have been on leave for some days, so I was not at the Business Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, get in touch with your Colleagues and let us do the needful.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, even if, there is always an afterthought. If I am not able to raise it at the Business Committee, nothing bars me from raising it on the Floor. Mr Speaker, it is a fact.

Another matter that is pending is that the Table Office is being told by the Hon Majority Leader that they should seek the availability of the Minister before Questions are programmed. That is wrong and against our practice. He cannot do that; we cannot do that. The Table Office goes through a certain motion and they give notice to the Ministers. The Ministers, where they cannot appear, must write formally to us. So, we have over 300 Questions, we are not answering the Questions, and all of them are being deferred. Those that are even being advertised on the *Order Paper*, we cannot take them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You just told us that you took leave. So, would it be fair to programme a Minister to come and answer a Question while on leave?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I think that I will not take this matter beyond a certain level. And I am not being a litigant. I am saying that—I have sat there. They were here. In fact, the Majority Leader, I can point his seat to you. He sat here.

[The Hon Member pointed at a space behind him at the Frontbench]

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Dafeamekpor was there and we had Mr Ablakwa here. Mr Speaker himself was here. *[Laughter]* Mr Speaker, the telepathy and the chemistry.

Mr Speaker, the gun has now been turned on you.

3:39 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I do not want you to remind me of my days in opposition.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Why is the Hon Majority Leader shielding the Ministers? He should allow them to come. They said they have achieved so much within one year and yet — Seriously, I want to plead with the Hon Majority Leader that I am available for suggestions. The Hon Majority Leader would recall that I came to him and suggested that we should advertise all the outstanding referrals. Now, there are about 300 of them. Then, we put pressure on the Committee leadership to work. I am a man of peace. We want to work. We want to help the Hon Majority leader to constitute Government Business but he is not helping himself. So, we want a good response to the questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will call on the Chairman of the Business Committee to respond to the issues raised.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I have not finished, he should wait.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I thought you said I should call on him to respond. Oh, Hon Annoh-Dompreh!

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: The Hon Majority should please sit down. Mr Speaker, will you not allow me to speak?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader and Chairman of the Business Committee?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, on listed referrals, the Appointments Committee indeed has a referral, specifically, the consideration of the nomination of a new Chief Justice. The indication I have from the Chairman of the Committee is that on Monday, the Committee will meet to consider the nomination of the new Chief Justice by the President. So, I think it was an oversight that the Table Office did not add that to the list of referrals.

Regarding office air conditioners, yes, some air conditioners are not working. There is a procurement process to procure the replacement of some essential parts that will enable all the air conditioners in those offices to function effectively. I appreciate that in the interim, some level of inconvenience is being suffered by Hon Members whose air conditioners are not working. So, I want to assure the House that we will expedite the procurement process so that they can expeditiously address that problem. In the interim, I think we will take on board the proposal for extending the closing time of the library. That is a matter that I will take up with the Clerk-to-Parliament if they can extend the closing time of the library.

I also heard one of our Colleagues, the Hon Member for Nalerigu raise the issue of air conditioners being the reason for absenteeism. I have been in this House long enough. What we see now as offices are actually recent additions to this Parliament. I am sure the Hon Nitiwul would recall that in the days when he was a Whip, we did not have offices, yet we came to this House, sat in this Chamber and we executed our

constituents' business and Government Business. So, I do agree that we need to urgently fix the air conditioners. But the challenges with the air conditioners cannot be grounds for not showing up. If we publicly indicate that when air conditioners in our offices are not working, we should stay away from our work. Our work, in addition to sitting in the office, is actually being in this Chamber and executing our constituents' business and Government Business. We are essentially telling civil servants that when the air conditioners in the offices are also not functioning, they should also not go to work and provide services to the public. So, we can raise the issues, but the way that we raise the issues send wrong signals out there. We need to be measured in the way that we dramatise the Friday Business Statement time. I understand the drama and the politics behind Friday Business Statement time. But let us be careful what we say and how people will interpret it out there.

Microphones in committee rooms. It is also not true that the microphones are faulty. I have observed that people do not know how to press the part of the microphone that would give us an indication to speak. Some of them are a bit defective now, so we need to press so hard sometimes before we are given the indication to go ahead and speak. I have experienced that also in a number of committee rooms. But a lot of the microphones are working. So, we cannot say that microphones are not working *et cetera*. When they keep making those statements, I can understand that the objective might just be to create an impression that things are not working,

but things are working. As we speak, we are on live television. A year ago, were we on live television anytime that we sat in this Chamber? So, things are working. There are improvements. Let us acknowledge the improvements and that things have become better, then we can move on.

I also noted that an Hon Colleague raised the issue of the Question numbered 454, which is a Question that has been asked already but has been repeated. So, the Table Office should take note that Question number 454 has already been repeated. I also agree that we should consider having the Committee of the Whole meeting on Tuesday in preparation for the Budget presentation on Thursday.

Also, I think that we need to put the issue of Questions in proper perspective. Our own Standing Orders are very clear on Questions. Order 77(2) says that,

“Question time shall ordinarily not exceed one hour except that the Speaker may permit a Question after the expiration of the time stated”.

So, the Clerks in the Table Office have to be measured in terms of the number of Questions that can be asked in any given day, in order to fit into the one-hour time that the Standing Orders dictate must be allocated for Questions. That could influence the number of Questions that can be asked on any given day.

Even then, the records do not bear out what the Hon Minority Chief Whip indicated because yesterday alone, I think we had over 16 Questions asked. If we go to the *Votes and Proceedings*, unless a Minister does not show up for some good reason, you would see that averagely, we have about 16 Questions asked. And we always exceed the time allocated by our own Standing Orders for asking Questions. When we brought in the question of making sure that the Table Office reached out to Ministers directly when scheduling Questions, it was to make sure that the Ministers are aware that they have been scheduled. This is because at the Business Committee meeting, the Hon Minority Chief Whip was not there, but his Colleagues were there. If he was there, he would understand the context in which the issue was raised because there was complaint that Ministers do not show up to answer Questions, and it was raised during Business Statement time.

3:49 p.m.

So, at the Business Committee's meeting, I raised the issue with the clerks that there are complaints in the Chamber that Ministers do not show up to answer Questions. I inquired if they normally ensure that the Minister is aware that they have been scheduled to answer Questions on those given dates; I asked the clerk, and she said that there is a schedule officer that she deals with in the Ministry. So, I said no, the schedule officer may also not be communicating to the Minister.

If the clerk does that and the Minister is not aware, the Minister would not show up. And if he does not show up, Members would raise the issue of Ministers not attending to Parliament to answer Questions. I said henceforth, the clerk should make sure that in scheduling a minister, the Minister should be informed by directly calling the Minister because they have the telephone numbers of the Ministers. The schedule officers are not the ones that Parliament is calling upon to come and answer Questions.

So, if the clerk calls a schedule officer and she does not call the Minister, and a Member comes to complain that the Minister has not shown up to answer a Question, is the Minister the one that has been informed about the Question? I told the clerk that if she cannot reach a minister, my job as Leader of Government Business is to make sure that I help to reach that minister. Is that not what I said at the meeting? So, if the clerk cannot reach a minister, she can reach me and let me know. I would make sure I reach that minister. There and then, I said let us try it today.

In the presence of all Members of the Committee, we called the Ministers one after the other. Some actually did not know that we had scheduled them to answer Questions and some indicated that the date that we had scheduled, they were unavailable. So, we shifted and rescheduled those who were unavailable on the dates and that became her example. Since then, I always ask her and she indicates that she is able to reach the Ministers.

I indicated at Conclave that the Minister may not be able to attend today. It does not mean that the Question may not be asked today because the Minister has sent his deputy and so I would ask permission from the Speaker so that the deputy would answer the Question.

Mr Speaker, this issue about conferring with Ministers in order to schedule their Questions being misrepresented that I am shielding Ministers is clearly wrong. Again, let us get back to Order 77(3) of the Standing Orders of Parliament, which says:

“A Minister, a Member or the Head of an Independent Constitutional Body shall not take more than three weeks, upon receipt of a Question from the House, to respond to the Question.”

A Minister can tell you that he would answer the Question in the second week. He can also tell you that he would answer the Question in the third week. But he cannot take more than three weeks. So, the right of Ministers within the three weeks to determine the schedule is also protected by the Standing Orders. We cannot say that he must come the first week: we cannot. Our own rules tell him that he has three weeks to answer the Question. It means that he has three weeks to send his officers. If one asks the Minister a Question to find out why the clinic at Bador in the Bawku Central Constituency has not been roofed, he needs to send somebody to the clinic to confirm that indeed the clinic has not been roofed, find out from the district health officer why the clinic has not been

roofed, and the district health officer has to send him a written report so that when he comes to this House he can give Hon Members an accurate response. That is why they are given the three weeks to gather the information to be able to respond to Hon Members. It is only in exceptional cases that one can ask an Urgent Question because it is indeed an urgent matter and we compel them to come and answer it as an Urgent Question. But any ordinary Question that one asks of a Minister, that Minister has three weeks to prepare and come and answer that Question and that is not negotiable, because it is in our rules. It is not the Ministers who enacted the rules.

So, nobody is shielding any Minister. I want to make sure that the Ministers are in the Chamber to answer Questions and so they must be aware that they have indeed been slated to come and answer Questions. They also have a right to negotiate and then use the three weeks' window that we have given them in our own rules.

Mr Speaker, I think I have responded to all the issues raised by Members — on the issue of the elevator, it is being worked on. There are several elevators so let us also be careful when we create the impression that the elevator is faulty. We have six elevators so if one elevator is faulty, we have five extra elevators. If two are faulty, we have four extra elevators. This is not the first time an elevator is developing problems in this Parliament. So they should not create the impression that the infrastructure has suddenly broken down. If anything at all, we know that some aspects of the

infrastructure have been enhanced. So, the elevators are being fixed. Whenever there is a breakdown, the engineers are called upon to come and then fix them. But I also think that we need to monitor the use of the elevators. Some elevators have been reserved for Members of Parliament, and other elevators also made available to the general public visiting us. We also observed that Members allow visitors to use the elevators reserved for Members of Parliament. Also, Members' assistants are always in the elevators going up and down causing wear and tear. So please urge your assistants in the offices to keep to the public elevators while the elevators reserved for the Members of Parliament are reserved for the Members of Parliament. If the wear and tear on those elevators are minimised, Members would have the elevators serving their purposes for long periods before they are serviced in order for the elevators to be fully functional. I think that we also need to pay attention to the way in which we use those facilities.

Mr Speaker, I think I have answered all the Questions asked by Members on the Business Statement that I have presented.

Thank you.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I thank the Leader for his response. Let me say for the record that my earlier submission was not to interpret Order 77 (3) of the Standing Orders in my own understanding. In fact, Order 77 (3) of the Standing Orders of Parliament is clear but I want to put on record that the

respected Majority Leader should check from the Table Office the outstanding Questions, *vis-a-vis* the Ministries who have been communicated to, and look at the time elapsed whether they do not stand in default of the three weeks' provision.

I also spoke in a certain context that when the Budget is presented and we go for post-Budget hearing, the rest of it is Motions for the approval of estimates and we cannot practically take Questions. So, my suggestion to the Majority Leader is that in the face of the circumstance we find ourselves where Budget is here and we are going to be taking over 50 Motions, we have to get innovative and make sure that these Questions are dispensable. I hope he gets it clear. I am not out there to create any mischief or unnecessary attention. No!

This is the Parliament of Ghana, and 300 Questions is quite a lot. We have to look at how as Leadership, we can find a way to get these Questions dealt with.

I thank you Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: On that note, I have a suggestion to the Leaders. If we can suggest to Members that during the time of supplementary questions, we would avoid arguments and comments before asking the supplementary question, it would help us to deal with so many Questions within a day. Because when it comes to supplementary questions, how many people do we give the opportunity to ask supplementary questions?

3:59 p.m.

So, if all those things could be ironed out, we can do a lot in terms of Questions in a day within the one hour.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I raised this issue at Business Committee meeting, and the impression created was that I am trying to silence Members of Parliament (MPs), but that is not the case. In most Parliaments in the world, even the number of Questions that a Member of Parliament can ask in a Sitting or a Meeting is clearly known. In this Parliament, people ask all sort of Questions, and they ask as many questions as they want. [*Uproar*]

Mr Speaker, last week, a Minister was summoned to this House to answer a Question about how many shrines are in this country—[*Uproar*—and the Minister came and answered the Question on how many shrines are in this country? Our own Standing Orders say that Question time is one hour. Please, go and take the video clips of the Sittings of this House and ask yourself, do we ourselves, as Members of Parliament in this Chamber, keep to our own Rules? The Rules say one hour. Do we keep to that Rule? The Table Office sometimes struggle to schedule Questions being asked of Hon Ministers within the one-hour time according to our Standing Orders. And that is why you see that they cannot schedule all the Questions so, let us also be mindful. Then also, when we ask Questions in order to elicit information about our constituencies.

Written answers can be provided to some of the Questions.

So, when an Hon Member asks how innovative we can be, we can be as innovative as asking Questions that just require written responses so that the Member has the information to share with our constituents. But if we want to ask the Questions and have it answered in the Chamber, and then sometimes we are begging Hon Members to be circumspect in terms of the number of follow-up questions so that a lot more questions can be asked, people will say no. So, if we start insisting on the Rules, I am sure we would not be able to accommodate even the 300. And we can also agree that even as we consider the Budget, we will still try and then accommodate a certain number of Questions every Sitting day.

Mr Speaker, so I think the issue of Questions is a matter that all of us must work on in order to address that challenge. But I can assure Members that I have no intention to shield any Minister. I can assure us of that. I also think that we should manage our time well in this Chamber in order to have the best in terms of output. And let us know how we do the follow-up questions so that we can ask many more questions every day. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Leader.

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Chairman of the Business Committee, in presenting the Business Statement, had

the occasion to answer a Question regarding a referral to the Appointments Committee. He indicated that the Appointments Committee has programmed the acting Chief Justice, my Lord Paul Baffoe-Bonnie, for vetting on Monday, 10th November, 2025.

Mr Speaker, we are here to approve the Business Committee's Report as a House. And the Rule allows us to amend, reject, modify the Report that is presented to us. It is my contention that in view of precedence of this House in respect of matters involving the rule of sub judice, this House cannot be invited to accept the vetting of the nominee for the Office of Chief Justice when indeed there are pending constitutional matters before the Supreme Court of this Republic and before the ECOWAS Court of Justice.

Mr Speaker, just for the avoidance of doubt and to lay a proper foundation for the submission I heretofore make, I shall rely on the *Official Report* of this House dated the 5th of March, 2025. I will start from column 140 and read portions of column 142. It reads:

“Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, that is the point I am making. The point I am making is that there are two grounds on which I am raising the objection. The first ground is that under our Constitution, we must not interfere with the work of the Judiciary. So, if the Judiciary is already seized with a matter, Parliament should not also take up that same matter and refer it to its Human Rights Committee. Parliament will be interfering with

the work of the Judiciary. Under the Constitution, we owe the Judiciary a duty not to interfere with their work. And my argument is that, we are taking up the matter and referring it to our Human Rights Committee to also inquire into, would be interfering with the work of the Judiciary. That is my first argument.”

Mr Dafeamekpor — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I recognise the Majority Chief Whip?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well, Mr Speaker. You may recognise him.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I humbly draw your attention to Order 71(1) to (3). The business before the House is the presentation of the Business Statement and comments arising therefrom. The Minority Leader on his feet is not addressing matters arising out of the Business Statement—[*Uproar*]—Please—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Minority Whip, are you on a point of order against a point of order?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I have not yielded. These are very serious matters.

4:09 p.m.

The Hon Minority Leader, instead of speaking to matters arising out of the

Business Statement that has been presented, is seeking to bring in a matter that is before the court, and to seek to say that Parliament by that process is injunctioned from performing its constitutional duties, referencing a matter in the *Hansard* that arose some time ago. In any case, the courts have decided, in *Dafeamekpor v Attorney-General*, when I sought to injunction this Parliament from vetting 13 Ministers nominated by the President at the time. The Supreme Court told me that I cannot injunction this Parliament from performing its constitutional functions. Additionally, our own Brother, Mr Assafuah, went to court, and the court, in *Assafuah v Attorney-General*, decided that this Parliament cannot be injunctioned from performing its constitutional duties.

So, the matter is settled, and the Hon Minority Leader cannot seek to rehash a matter that has already been settled by the Supreme Court. He is wasting our time. [*Uproar*] If he intends to raise an issue arising out of the Business Statement presented, he should do so.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, if you do not want to listen, others are minded to listen.

Mr Dafeamekpor: He should do so. He should stop bringing in the scheduled vetting of the Chief Justice on Monday because it will happen. [*Hear! Hear!*] This House will perform its constitutional duties. The Supreme Court has already settled the matter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, be brief.

Mr Dafeamekpor: A mere filing of a case — [*Uproar*]— In any case, the matter before the court is a *certiorari* application.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, be brief.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, Mr Speaker, I am being brief. But let us settle the matters on the law. The application before the court is a *certiorari* application. There is no injunction application before the court. It is an application of *certiorari* seeking the court to prevent Parliament from performing its constitutional duties, and that application will be heard at a definitive date. But in the meantime, the Supreme Court says Parliament must continue to perform its constitutional duties. So, that matter, the Hon Minority Leader should not go there. [*Uproar*] It is trite; it is settled and he knows.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I intend to give the floor to the Hon Minority Leader to conclude.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I come to this Chamber prepared and fortified. I do not make lame submissions. A Member can decide to make a statement *ex cathedra*. I would rely on authority. That is what I seek to do, and I move on a ground of relevance.

Mr Speaker, I was on the path of quoting Mr Ayariga; I will continue. He continues.

“And my argument is that we are taking up the matter and referring it to our Human Rights Committee to

enquire into. We would be interfering with the work of the Judiciary. That is my first argument.”

He continues at column 142, and this is what he says:

“Even though ordinarily we wait until the person is making a statement and we think the statement is going to prejudice the interests of parties, then we object. But here, I am saying that the very language of the Motion already prejudices what it is saying we should do and what it is saying we should not, apart from offending the Constitution. We say we should not interfere in the work of the Judiciary. In moving it, there is no way that he will not say things that will not prejudice the interests of parties in substantive litigation. Why the hurry?”

That is Mr Ayariga, the Majority Leader of the 9th Parliament, invited the Rt Hon Speaker to hold that because there was a Henry Nana Boakye case at the Supreme Court—By the way, the gravamen of his objection was the fact that Henry Nana Boakye had filed a constitutional matter at the Supreme Court. Therefore, my application should not be moved at all, which objection was sustained by the Speaker?

Now, let us hear what the Speaker’s ruling was.

“Hon Members, the Motion, Private Member’s Motion numbered 16, at page 6 of today’s Order Paper, was scheduled to be moved.”

Then he continues:

“The Speaker may, in a particular case where it is quite obvious, refuse to admit a Motion, especially when it is covered by a clearcut case. For example, if you put forward a Motion affecting a matter which is pending in court directly and it was brought to the knowledge of Mr Speaker, he is bound to draw attention to the fact that such a Motion cannot be properly debated by the House and therefore cannot be accepted. But it does not follow that in every case where a motion is accepted and listed, the Speaker has necessarily gone through the Motions of deciding every issue of propriety involved in that Motion.”

The Speaker continues in his ruling:

“Hon Members, regarding the Motion at hand, I am reliably informed that at the time the Rt Hon Speaker admitted the Motion, the fact of an action pending at the Supreme Court regarding the subject matter was not brought to his attention. Based on the above precedent, the House must stay its hand off the Motion and allow other organs of state...”

I repeat:

“... the House must stay its hands off the Motion and allow other organs of state properly mandated under the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, that is the

Judiciary, to deal with the matter. Accordingly, the Motion and subsequent debate on it is stayed pending the determination of the matter by the Supreme Court.”

This was not a matter of injunction. Mr Speaker, according to the Hon Majority Leader, there is going to be vetting, and the Majority Chief Whip attempted to arrogate the full powers of this House to himself, as if we are dealing with a one-man show of power in this country by saying that it will happen. We are not into blows; we are here to argue law and for you to determine. So, this kind of attack that it will happen—We argue for posterity. Democracy and practice are for posterity. So, they should take it easy.

Mr Speaker, let me draw your attention to detailed provisions in our Standing Orders. First, Order 217 (2), on the *sub judice* rule Order 103 (f) and 123 (1), and on the Speaker’s control of the Business of the House, guided by Order 216 (4). None of these expressly contemplates the co-existence of an active constitutional dispute over legality of vacancy, the vetting that is being announced seeks to fill. We have a situation at hand: one is the procedure under Order 217 that empowers Appointments Committee to consider a nomination when existence of the vacancy itself is *sub judice*.

4:19 p.m.

Are we going to do that? That the Appointments Committee, knowing that there is a *sub judice* matter, will still

proceed to consider the vetting? Whereas the Constitution contemplates that the Office of Chief Justice will never be vacant, that is why even when the former Chief Justice was originally suspended, there was an acting Chief Justice. So, there should be no hurry. Nobody should contemplate that Parliament is somewhat estopped. That seat is not vacant. However, proceeding to vet a new person to fill that Office would be rendering the application of Justice Gertrude Esaaba Torkornoo, otiose.

Mr Speaker, the second is constitutional. We would be proceeding on the path that would amount to a legislative interference with judicial process contrary to Article 125(3) and 127(2), which vests judicial power exclusively in the courts and oblige all state organs to protect their independence and effectiveness.

Mr Speaker, under Order 20 of our Standing Orders;

“The Speaker is a head of the institution of Parliament and presides over the sittings of Parliament.”

Order 20 (4) also reads;

“The Speaker shall
(a) uphold the honour, dignity and the sanctity of the House...”

Mr Speaker, if you read this provision or together with the relevant provisions that protect the independence of the Constitution, we are being called

upon to ensure that Parliament is never seen as bringing any other state organ into disrepute.

Mr Speaker, as you sit there, you have a duty to uphold the honour, dignity and sanctity of the House. If this whole Parliament, in view of its own precedence—Not long ago, in March, when Osahen Afenyo-Makin, Alhaji Habib-Idrisu and Mr Vincent Assafuah had an application, which application was to determine a governance and practice issue, the Majority Leader argued strenuously that indeed, that matter had a constitutional issue attached thereto. Therefore, I should be restrained from moving the Motion.

Mr Speaker, that was his contention. Much as I argued that the matter before the House had nothing to do with the court matter, the House still ruled, by your very good self. You presided and told us that indeed, because the matter was before the courts, we could not take the Motion.

Mr Speaker, let me refer to Erskine May, 26th Edition, paragraph 2011, I quote;

“The House has resolved that no matter awaiting adjudication by a court of law should be brought before it.”

If a matter is awaiting adjudication, this House must stay its hands, that is the law and that is the practice. How then would the Majority Leader, in presenting the Business Statement, invite us to

accept, as part of the it, the vetting of the Nominee on Monday, 10th November, 2025, when he is aware that the ECOWAS court has scheduled 18th November, 2025, for the ruling in the matter brought before it? Where does this House want to hurry to? Why are we in a haste to render the outcome of the case negatory and otiose to deny, the former Chief Justice of the Republic, her rights to occupy her office? [*Uproar*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, conclude.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, it is public knowledge that the learned Attorney-General and Minister for Justice has so far even refused to file a defence in the matters at the Supreme Court. It was only last week that he filed a Motion for leave to file for extension of time, to file. All these are happening in this country; a country of rule of law and Parliament would want to shut its eyes on this?

Mr Speaker, the man empowered with the mandate to empanel the courts, is himself the very person who has been nominated. So far, whereas he was in a hurry to empanel the court to hear the injunction applications, none has happened in any of the six cases. There is a High Court matter, where the Justice Torkornoo challenged the warrant of her removal, while the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice has filed an application seeking constitutional interpretation. It has been weeks that my Lord Justice Baffoe-Bonnie, who alone has the power to empanel the court, has not empaneled the court.

In fact, none of the cases involving my Lady Torkornoo, as well as our respected Colleague Vincent Assafuah, has received the blessing of the court for the purpose of hearing. Meanwhile, the time for hearing has long lapsed, with the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice not filing any process and now seeking the leave of the court, belatedly, for extension of time. I dare submit that the man who is going to be nominated, himself, is conflicted. He is in conflict. How can he, who knows that the occupant of the Office is being denied her human rights and is supposed to empanel, is refusing to empanel. Yet, this House should bless him with the benefit of vetting.

Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader cannot invite us—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I am pleading with you to conclude.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: I am concluding.

Mr Speaker, these are preliminary matters; we have our own matters to deal with. But we want to bring it in the context of the Business Committee Report and invite the Majority Leader, to graciously withdraw that aspect of his submission to the effect that, on Monday there is going to be a vetting. We will not support a Business Committee Report that has an aspect that says that there is going to be vetting.

Mr Speaker, in any effect—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, do you have the Business Statement?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, the Business Statement—I have been a Majority Leader before.

4:29 p.m.

When the Business Statement is presented, questions are asked, inputs are made, and the Majority Leader, also Leader of Government Business, confirms certain provisions, and it becomes part of the Report. That is it. *[Uproar]*

Mr Speaker, with respect, he has confirmed that there has been a programme. So, let us not belabour. It is a fact. We are saying that he should withdraw that bit so that the original component of the Business Committee's report remains without any vetting whatsoever on Monday.

In any event, we, the Minority, as law-abiding as we are, filed a Motion several days ago and have done several follow-ups. Our Minority should not be taken for granted. **[Some Hon Members:** At all!] It should never be taken for granted. We are encouraged at all times to be law-abiding, follow procedure and be vigilant in that process. So, Mr Speaker, awaiting all of this, the Majority Leader cannot just announce to us that Justice Araba Esaaba Torkornoo's prayer does not matter. She is a Ghanaian who was appointed. She has submitted herself to all due process, and her rights must be respected.

This Parliament must, with the greatest respect, rely on its own precedent, not long ago, and allow the Court to determine the matter. It should be our collective call on the active Chief Justice to quickly empanel the Court. It must be our collective voice to encourage the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice to go to ECOWAS Court and file a defence, rather than being threatened by the Chief Whip of the Majority that vetting will happen with all his might. We are not dealing with might. That vetting will not happen: it will not happen. They must follow due process. Follow the law. Do the right thing. We, the Minority, will not shut our mouths.

[Some Members of the Minority chanted "follow due process"]

Mr Speaker, I want to conclude by saying that my submission does not in any way seek a ruling from you; I am rather seeking the indulgence of the Majority Leader, who knows the rules, to do the needful by withdrawing this aspect of the Report that there is going to be a vetting.

Mr Speaker, we know how to move our case and will do the needful. But this one is not a Motion we bringing up for you to make a ruling. That said, I will rest my case and hear the Majority Leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think it is important, first and foremost, that we are reminded at all times that we are not just speaking to ourselves, but we are also speaking to a wider audience. I always make it a point, as much as I can,

to speak directly to the wider audience by trying to break down things to a very basic level. When we break down things to a very basic level, sometimes people who think they know realise that they actually do not know, and then they will appreciate it.

Now, the Chief of Staff had issued some directives regarding some recruitments that happened after the National Democratic Congress (NDC) came into office. Somebody went to the Supreme Court to try and get the Court to intervene and determine that the action of the Chief of Staff was unconstitutional and a violation of the rights of those individuals.

Then the Minority Leader brought a Motion to this House, urging this House to make some decisions regarding the action of the Chief of Staff. So I raised an objection on the grounds that, because someone has already gone to court to vindicate the rights of the people who were dismissed, it will amount to interference in the work of the courts if this Parliament goes into that matter. This Parliament was asked to act in a matter that was quasi-judicial once a judicial process was already underway.

So, I said we will be interfering in the work of the courts if they have started a judicial process of determining the rights or otherwise of those dismissed. Then he also comes to this Parliament and says we should also start another process of determining the rights or otherwise of the same people. That will interfere with the work of the Judiciary because their main responsibility, constitutionally, is to

vindicate rights. We primarily are to enact legislation, hold the executive accountable, and sometimes hold the Judiciary accountable. So our position is secondary to that of the Judiciary in this matter. That was the context, and that is how the Speaker concluded that I was right in that instance, and therefore, his Motion should not be admitted.

Now, let us come to this present instance about the Appointments Committee. In this instance, he is saying that a referral that has been made by the Speaker to a Committee of this House to exercise a function that constitutionally is within the province of that Committee—Because the Constitution is clear that there shall be Committees of Parliament and that when somebody is nominated to be a Chief Justice, this Parliament must give approval and the internal processes of this Parliament is to refer that nomination to the Committee to do what we now popularly call vetting and then present a report to us to consider and then approve. So a referral has been made to the Committee.

4:39 p.m.

He is saying that there is litigation in the Court regarding the propriety of the processes relating to the removal of the previous Chief Justice and because of this litigation regarding the processes leading to the removal of the previous Chief Justice, this Parliament should not consider a nomination brought to this Parliament, a nomination which the Speaker has accepted and referred to a committee for the Committee to process.

I, once again, draw Members attention to the fact that the same Supreme Court has said that in matters that are primarily the responsibility of Parliament, once Parliament starts dealing with those matters, no one anywhere can stop Parliament from dealing with those matters until it has completed the process of dealing with that matter. The Supreme Court has said that severally. The Hon Member just cited two cases in which Members of this House have gone to the Supreme Court to try and get the Supreme Court to order this House to stop considering matters that the House was considering on the grounds that they felt it was unconstitutional for Parliament to consider those matters. Similar to what the Minority Leader is raising today, that because there is litigation, the matter should not be dealt with by the Appointments Committee. The Supreme Court said no. In matters that are primarily within the mandate of Parliament, the Supreme Court, will not interfere until they have finished, and we have seen the outcome of their work. It is the outcome of their work that we may examine the quality but not the process. This is a very simple, I mean, I tried to be so basic because I want the students who are sitting out there [*Pointing at the Public Gallery*] to understand the conversation that is going on.

[*Hear! Hear!*]

Hon Minority Leader, reference to the 1992 Constitution, *Erskine May*, and to all those things do not really make a difference. The matter is so simple and so basic. The Supreme Court of Ghana has said that when this Parliament is

engaged in its primary responsibility, it will always allow this Parliament to go through that process to the end. If the outcome is wrong or goes against a specific provision of the Constitution, then they, at that point, can make that determination. But once they are seized with jurisdiction and they are dealing with the matter, they will not interfere. I have not seen a ruling changing this position of the Supreme Court.

As for the ECOWAS, yes, even the ECOWAS Court will always say that one should have fully exhausted local remedies before one comes to the ECOWAS Court. So, if one is already in the courts of Ghana, trying to vindicate their rights, the person has not finished in Ghana, then the person jumps to Abuja when they have not yet exhausted local remedies. I will be surprised if ECOWAS Court delves into the matter. I am saying this because I have been a member of the ECOWAS Parliament for close to a decade, and I know how their court functions. So, I can assure Members, without making any pronouncements now, that the principle at the ECOWAS Court is that one must have exhausted local remedies before going to ECOWAS Court.

Mr Speaker, I plead with my Colleagues. I know that the circumstances surrounding the removal of the former Chief Justice is a matter that, especially my Brother, the Hon Minority Leader, has fought, embarked on street marches and in the process, some policemen even alleged that he became physical against them. [*Laughter*] I can understand that this is a

matter that he is personally very passionate about. But, the 1992 Constitution is very clear on these matters. The nomination of the Chief Justice is properly before this House. It has been referred to the Committee and the Committee will sit on Monday. *[Hear! Hear!]* I urge him to appear before the Committee as a Member. He can ask all his questions. The Chief Justice nominee is ready, available, and willing to answer all questions put to him. He is very capable. If, at the end of the day, there is any decision by any court in this country, I am sure the courts will find a way of crafting a mechanism for enforcing their decision.

Mr Speaker, the courts, after we have completed our work in this House, have been able to strike down the conclusion of the work of this House. In that ruling led by Justice Emmanuel Yonny Kulendi, they annulled what we did in this House. So, please, allow the system to work.

Hon Members, I have presented to you the Business Statement for next week. The Hon Minority Leader and the Hon Minority Chief Whip are members of the Business Committee. So, this Business that we have presented to the House is business that we agreed together as the business of the house for next week, and we urge you to approve it so that we can move on.

As for the referral to the Committee, that was done some time ago. It was not really part of the records of the Business Statement of this sitting. It was not. It is an old referral. What we did is to attach

records of the old referrals to remind Hon Members that those referrals are pending before them. It is not a matter for decision today. The work of these Committees are not matters for decision today. It is just to remind Hon Members that these assignments are pending before them. So, the question of the Appointments Committee and what they are to do on Monday is not for decision today. It is a matter already referred by the Speaker to them. If a Member wants to challenge the decision of the Speaker on that matter, the person knows the procedure to use. Members know the procedure for challenging a decision that has been taken. The Speaker has already taken a decision referring the nomination to the Appointments Committee. All we are doing is to remind all Committees that businesses are pending before them that they should endeavour to accomplish those businesses and bring their reports to us for decision.

So one cannot get up and like somebody did in secondary school exams where the question was, what is a tree? Then he says, 'a tree has branches, sometimes birds perch on the trees and one may ask, what is a bird?

4:49 p.m.

Then he went on a tangent of explaining and describing a bird because that is what he had prepared for in the exams. *[Laughter]* I am saying this because I know as a fact that he had filed a Motion seeking to challenge the authority of this House to have the nominee considered by the Appointments Committee. He raised it at

Conclave and I reminded him that he cannot stop this Parliament from conducting its lawful business. I reminded him and he told me that he had prepared to argue that Motion and that even if I wanted, he would give me copies of his arguments that he would proffer. That is why I am saying that he had prepared on an examination about the birds. *[Uproar]* He had prepared to argue a motion on the constitutionality of this House considering the nomination of the Chief Justice. So even though that Motion is not properly before this House and what is before this House is the Business Statement for the ensuing week, he decided to argue his Motion. *[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, conclude.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the issues that he has raised are not properly before us. There is no issue about the sitting of the Appointments Committee. That is a matter decided already by this House. What is before us is the Business Statement so that we can schedule activities for next week. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, with all due respect, the Hon Minority Leader, in raising the issue, indicated that he is not calling on the Speaker to make a ruling. So, if there is an issue raised which the Speaker is not called upon to make a ruling, do we open it up for debate? Hon Members, with all due respect, he came out clearly to state that he is raising the issue but not calling on me to make a ruling. We cannot therefore open this for a debate, with all

due respect. So, Hon Minority Leader, I will give you the floor if you have something to say, then we make progress. But I do not intend to open this up for debate because I am not being called upon to make a ruling. Procedurally, if the Hon Minority Leader raises an issue and is not calling for a ruling, why do we debate this matter? Hon Minority Leader, I plead with you to be brief.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, first, perhaps what my two Hon Colleagues who were up on their feet, sought to do was to seek your leave to contribute to the Business Statement. Mr Speaker, the subject matter of this whole discourse is the Business Statement. I will come in to respond to the issues that I disagree with.

Mr Speaker, he made some fundamental points.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Minority Leader, with all due respect to you, if you intend to respond to what he is saying, it would be fair and just that before we take comments on the Business Statement, we conclude the issue that you have raised, then I can give them the floor to comment on the Business Statement.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, if that is not —

Mr Ayariga — *rose* —

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Let me finish. Mr Speaker, you give me the right then you can —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let me hear the Hon Majority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Before you come back to me?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. Do not worry.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we all know the practices of this House. When the Business Statement is read, we start with comments from Backbenchers, to the Seniors and then we end with the Leaders. So, no one, unless there is something earth-shattering, after the Minority Leader has commented on the Business Statement —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In fact, without cutting you short, I had the privilege of discussing this with some Leaders from the Minority Side, that it is not always fair and just, that we wait and give opportunity for our Leaders, then after Leader speaks, then the back will want to have the opportunity to speak again. It is not a good practice. It does not sound well. So, Leaders, I plead with you that anytime you want to speak, look behind you. I even raised this on the floor of this House, that it is always good to look behind you, because a Leader must speak last. A chief must speak last.

Yes, Hon Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I am guided by the fact that our Leaders have spoken on this matter,

and it is the Business Statement that the House needs to take a decision to either adopt it or have the Hon Majority Leader make amends; that is what is stated in our Standing Orders in Order 71.

Mr Speaker, I want to draw your attention to something, as much as we are taking the decision on the Business Statement, I want to refer you to Article 104 of the 1992 Constitution. Article 104 of the 1992 Constitution states, and I read,

“(1) Except as otherwise provided in this Constitution, matters in Parliament shall be determined by the votes of the majority of members present and voting, with at least half of the members of Parliament present.”

Mr Speaker, for us to adopt this Business Statement, we are going to take a decision. And to take that decision we need 138 Members of Parliament present to do that, but we do not have that number. At the moment, we are 108 in this Chamber, so for that matter, Mr Speaker, we cannot adopt the Business Statement. We cannot take that decision. *[Uproar]* We do not have 138 Members present to take a decision or approve of the Business Statement. For that matter, Mr Speaker, I invite you to apply the provisions in the Constitution in Article 104. Mr Speaker, the Majority Side is 77 and we are only 35. We cannot take that decision to approve the Business Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib, I think your application is premature. We have not got to a stage of

taking a decision. The Hon Minority Leader has raised an issue and it is that issue that we are considering.
4:59 p.m.

Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, when Alhaji Habib Iddrisu was on his feet, he made reference to Order 71 and indicated that a decision is to be taken. That is the basis on which he is raising the question of the decision quorum. I rose because he specifically mentioned Order 71. Before he went to the 1992 constitutional provision, he mentioned Order 71. I think that we should read Order 71. Order 71 says:

“(1) Every Friday, the chairperson of the Business Committee shall present to the House, a statement on the business arranged for the following week.

(2) Where the first Sitting of a Meeting precedes a Friday, the statement on the business arranged for the remainder of the week, where possible, shall be presented on the day of the commencement of the Meeting.

(3) The chairperson of the Business Committee may present supplementary statements as determined by the Committee.”

Mr Speaker, a Statement, not a report to be adopted by this House. I want the

Hon Member to read his Standing Orders properly and understand it properly. The Order says the Chairperson should give a Statement. The same way that Statements are made in our Standing Orders. Which Statement has ever been made in this House that has had to be adopted by this House? This shows that we have been doing the wrong thing. I am very serious. I am reading Order 71 (1) which says,

“(1) Every Friday, the chairperson of the Business Committee shall present to the House, a statement on the business arranged for the following week.”

There is nothing that says that we should adopt it or make a decision. What we could do is that if I present the Business Statement and, in your commentary, there is additional Business that should be conducted by the House, then I make supplementary statements. Those supplementary Business Statement also provide notice of the other Businesses that may be done in addition.

A Business Statement is just a notice of what the agenda of the House is going to be. I do not think that there is a basis for raising an issue of constitutionality. There is no basis, because there is a Business Committee. When the Business Committee meets, they are regulated by the provisions relating to Committee work. This means that they have to adopt the outcome of their work. But when I come here as Chairperson of that Committee, I am not presenting a report that should be adopted by this House. I

am making a Statement outlining the agenda of this House for the subsequent week. That is the position.

Mr Speaker, I invite you to look at Order 71(1) and what it actually means. I know all the time when the Business Statement is made, Members get up and then they raise issues that they think should be included, then the Leader would say, “we would add that *et cetera*”. That is in the nature of the supplementary Business Statement. In the end, the Speaker would usually say, “the Business Statement is hereby adopted or put it to us...” Strictly speaking, a Business Statement is not a matter that should be adopted and accepted. It is a Business Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member conclude.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, when I raised my issue, the Majority Leader who says that the Order that I stated was wrong—Mr Speaker, this is my fifth year on the Front Bench, and when it comes to the Standing Orders, I know my Rules well. Majority Leader should read Order 101(a) which states:

“Notice shall be given of a Motion intended to be moved except a Motion

(a) for the adoption of the report of the Business Committee...”

[Uproar]

It is a Motion that needs to be adopted—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Order! Order!

Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, with all due respect, in adopting the Business Statement, do we put a question?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: I am drawing his attention to Standing Order 101.

Mr Speaker, how is a report in the parliamentary procedure adopted? A Business Statement is a report to the House which needs to be adopted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, you have indicated that you have been a Member of Parliament at the Front Bench for five years. So, with the five years' experience, do we adopt a Business Statement by putting a question?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Yes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Leader, do you want to help us, whether a Business Statement is adopted by putting a question? Minority Leader, let me hear you. Before you come in, permit me to acknowledge the presence of students in our midst.

We have students from Regional Maritime University, led by Okyere Nana Kwesi Baah, head of the Student Representative Council. They are from the Krowor Constituency and are 40 in number.

[Students of Regional Maritime University were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have Kingdom Heirs Montessori, led by Joseph Armah, who is the facilitator. They are from Bortianor Ngleshie Amanfrom and are 82 in number.

[Pupils from Kingdom Heirs Montessori were acknowledged]

5:09 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome all of them to the Parliament of the Republic of Ghana.

May you have a fruitful visit to Parliament. Thank you very much for coming.

Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am on my feet on two issues. First, our Side has a concern and it is a concern that is very collective. We have noticed that in many instances, when we are contributing, you interject with a lot of questions. However, the Majority Leader and his Colleagues on the Frontbench, as well as the majority Members, are allowed to flow. Mr Speaker, we would plead with you that as much as possible, as much as you give them the unfettered opportunity to make their submissions, please allow us also. Because many times, you interject with rhetorical questions and we sometimes read sarcasm in it. Unfortunately,

sometimes we do. Because if a Member makes a submission — *[Uproar]*

Mr Speaker, for the first time, I will take issue with the Majority Leader. Sometimes when we are all arguing and he disagrees, he has a way of using the language so offensive, but I have decided to always ignore.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I thought you were addressing me.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: I am not worried.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I thought you were talking about —

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I need to finish, respectfully. He uses a certain language. On the matter you referred to, his argument at the despatch box was to the effect that the Business Statement is a statement and not a report. He went further to say that for that matter, it does not need any numbers constitutionally provided to adopt it and that whatever we have been doing is wrong. The respected Member for Tolon got up to remind him of Order 101(a), which says that there are Motions that require notice and the Business Statement is one of the Motions that no notice is required, and it has to be adopted. Let us pay attention to the language of our own regulation. It talks about adoption. How do we adopt reports in this House? Any report that is adopted must meet the threshold constitutionally provided. So, he was on a firm ground when he said that to adopt the Business

Statement, we need a minimum of 138 Members.

He went further to say that at the time he was arguing, the majority had only 77, out of their 189. That is a statement that was made on record. And even now, as we count, they are now 82 and we are still counting the Majority Side—*[Uproar]*— Yes, so after all, your super majority exists merely in numbers. Today, we are using sum and substance to challenge you. We are facing you with substance. We are not facing you with numbers. We know when it comes to numbers, you have it. That is why we have enriched our argument by doing research. That is why the Member for Tolon is able to remind the Majority Leader that indeed, he did not make the application lamely. He did not bring a lame application.

Mr Speaker, let us even pay attention to paragraph 1 of the Business Statement. It reads:

“Mr Speaker, the Committee met yesterday, Thursday, 6th November, 2025, and arranged Business of the House for the Fourth Week ending Friday, 14th November, 2025. Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its report as follows.”

Mr Speaker, though the word ‘statement’ is used, but the content of that document is a report. He is the Chairperson of the Committee. Let us look at Order 216(1), which reads:

“The Business Committee comprises the Leader of Government Business

as Chairperson, the Leader of the party or parties in Parliament which do not form the Government as the Ranking Member, the Chief Whips and not more than eleven other Members.”

Mr Speaker, it goes on to talk about its proposed sitting and recommendations. Whatever the Business Committee does, it presents it to the House in the form of a report. And Standing Order 101(a) provides, and I quote again, for the avoidance of doubt, at the risk of being repetitive. It says:

“Notice shall be given of a Motion intended to be moved, except a Motion

(a) for the adoption of the report of the Business Committee.”

Let us read them together. This provision and the first paragraph of your own report and the conclusion: let us be very conjunctive. You cannot read them in isolation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, so reading all the provisions in totality, my question is not being sarcastic. It can lead us to resolve the matter ourselves, and that is the best approach. That is why my question is simple. How do we adopt a Business Committee’s report or a Business Statement?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the procedure for adopting a report in this Chamber has always been

by taking a vote, a voice vote and if it is challenged —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you have been in this House for a very long time. Can you mention one instance where we adopted a Business Committee's report by vote?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, how do we adopt a report in this House? The Majority Leader said if in the past we did not use a certain procedure, then it is wrong. That is what he said. He said we have adopted a wrong procedure.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I do not think we should set a very bad precedent by adopting a Business Committee's Statement by way of a vote. We would have been setting a very bad precedent for this House—*[Uproar]*— It has never happened before. I came here in 2013. In ruling government, it has never happened. I was in opposition for eight years, it has never happened. I am now in government and that is why I am saying that we should not set that bad precedent. The Seniors in this House can attest to the fact that we have never adopted a Business Statement by way of voting. It has never happened.

Hon Majority Leader, let me hear you.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, this *Order Paper* sets out the agenda for today. If you go to the item numbered 13 on page 5, it says "Motion —That this House adopts the Report of the Committee on Energy on the..."

So, this is a Motion requiring a vote and a decision. The same *Order Paper* at page 2 says "Business Statement". If it is a report, this *Order Paper* would have said a report to be adopted by a Motion. *[Uproar]*

Mr Speaker asked the Hon Minority Leader a simple question. How are Reports adopted in this House? Reports are adopted in this House through Motions and those Motions are advertised. So that is the point I am making to you.

5:19 p.m.

The point I am making is that this is not advertised as a Motion for decision. It is a simple Statement and I am saying that when a simple statement is made, it does not require a vote to adopt a Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I will take the Hon Minority Leader first. Hon Members, I am watching and the cameras are also on you. Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Hon Majority Leader cannot get away with what he just said. The Rules of this House define what the Business Statement is. It defines the Business Statement as a report and a Motion. That is what the Rule says. It is not me who says so; it is the Rules enacted by us.

Mr Speaker, in the hierarchy of laws, is Order Paper a Rule? When there is any conflict, the law always takes precedence over any other thing. Where the law has

provided in explicit terms that the Business Statement should come by way of a Motion which does not require notice and it has to be adopted, the Hon Majority Leader is urging upon this House to take it as a mere Statement. All what they are doing is to filibuster in order to increase their 82 to a comfortable number. We will not allow them—They are 82 in number.

Mr Speaker, you must determine the constitutional issue. We do not have 138 Members. They are now 74 Members, and we will not allow them to use delayed tactics to invite their Members to come into the Chamber. We are not up to 138 Members. If the Mr Speaker wants to make a ruling on this matter, he should and posterity will judge this House.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, on this note, I am being called upon to make a ruling. Let me hear Mr Ahmed Ibrahim.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: If you do not want to go by the Rules of this House and the Constitution—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I will make my ruling.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, let me conclude.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I thought you have concluded and calling on me to make a ruling.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: The Hon Majority Leader cannot choose at his convenience. When it pleases him, he says the Constitution; when it pleases

him, he says now his authority is *Order Paper*. He does not depend on Constitution and the Rules book. We challenge him with Order 101 (a). He has not commented on it; he does not want to respond to it. All he says is *Order Paper*.

Mr Speaker, a constitutional issue has been raised. You have to rule on it. We are not 138. They are 78.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, are you done? I will proceed to give the floor to the Hon Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, Mr Ahmed Ibrahim.

Mr Ahmed Ibrahim: Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr John Darko — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr John Darko, I recognise Hon Member for Banda, and not you. Mr Ibrahim, you have the floor.

Mr Ibrahim: Mr Speaker, with respect.

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Ayeh, will you resume your seat.

Mr Ibrahim: Mr Speaker, it is the responsibility of the Leadership of the House, including we, the former Leaders, to support you to maintain order in the House.

Mr Speaker, Parliament is a very serious House, governed by rules and

procedures. [*Uproar*] Today, most of the Cabinet Ministers, Mr Haruna Iddrisu, Alhaji Muntaka Mohammed-Mubarak, myself, and other Colleagues, after a Cabinet meeting moved to this House. Because of Business in Parliament, we closed at 2:00 p.m. We have been debating Business Statements for two hours. [*Uproar*]*—*The accusation is that Members on the Majority Side are not present. There are 87 Members on the Minority Side. As I speak, they have only 25 Members.

Mr Speaker, how can we come and sit here—[*Interruption*]*—*When we have 110 Members on the Majority Side while they have 25 Members. Mr Speaker, for us to spend two hours in debating Business Statement, when they know the correct thing to do—For the records we were on that Side. It is not beyond us to know what to do. As former and current Leaders, we know what to do.

Mr Speaker, if we may recall, what is happening today, has ever happened in this Chamber. How did we resolve it? They should know what to do. Mr Speaker, you are the Speaker, so long as this House is concerned. The Business Statement has been presented. It is within your jurisdiction and authority to give the ruling that the Business Statement is adopted, subject to your recommendations. Then we move on.

Mr Speaker, currently, there is no Motion before the House, and we cannot debate a Motion that has not been moved. They should know what to do.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Order!

Mr Ibrahim: Mr Speaker, you know, when Mid-year reviews were reduced to Statements, we stopped voting on them. So, if they do not know what to do and have not done it, they cannot hold us to ransom.

Mr Speaker, I am the Minister responsible for Local Government, Chieftaincy, and Religious Affairs, and from 2:00 p.m. I have been seated here debating Business Statement. On that note, Mr Speaker, so long as there is no Motion before the House, just move forward and let us adopt the Business Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Ayeh, if your Leaders are asking you to sit down, please resume your seat. At least, if you will not listen to me, listen to your Whips.

Yes, Mr Dafeamekpor, let me hear you, but be brief.

5:29 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I will be very brief.

Within the terms of Order 122, the Minority Leader put out some figures regarding my Membership on the Floor. Please—[*Uproar*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, if things continue this way, I will not hesitate to invoke the rules by calling on you to walk out. If you refuse, I will invite the Marshal to walk you out. This is the House of Parliament. It must not be so disorderly. The disorderly

conduct is becoming too much. We are honourable Members.

Yes, Hon Habib. No—Hon Rockson is on the floor.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I will be very brief. One, our Standing Orders define the terms of art. And this is contained in Order 6 of our Standing Orders. Business Statement is not defined. So the position by the Minority Leader that the Business Statement is defined and constitutes a Motion is inaccurate. It is not defined. He made a point that our Standing Orders defines the Business Statement but it has not been defined. So that is for the record.

Two, the Minority Leader has put out some figures regarding our Membership on the Floor. Our Membership is over 142 on this Floor. [*Hear! Hear!*] They are 26 and we are 142. So, Mr Speaker, it is a Friday political strategy to put it out in the media that Members of the Majority were 82. So that the media will take it out, and for the whole weekend, we will be bastardised.

Mr Speaker, let the records reflect that we are 142. A count can be conducted. They are 25. Mr Speaker, we have the numbers.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, if you want to know the actual number in the House, as Speaker, I know what to do. I will call on the clerks to do the counting.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, thank you. So I will not allow the number 82 to stand. We do not want the media to

go and report that the Members of the Majority are 82; we are 142.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have spent so much time on the Business Statement. To everything, there must be an end. I am pleading with you to conclude issues on the Business Statement, so we can make progress.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I would not say much except that I have a pending application. I want to draw your attention also to Standing Order 20 (4) (a) (b) (c) and (d). Order 20 (4) (a) says that:

“The Speaker shall

- (a) uphold the honour, dignity, and sanctity of the House;
- (b) promote consensus on matters under consideration in the House;
- (c) be impartial, fair and firm in every matter in the performance of functions of the Speaker in these Orders;”

Mr Speaker, I want to invite you to abide by this. So far, you have steered the affairs of the House very well. But I raised an issue that Article 104 of the 1992 Constitution states that matters to be determined in this House must be at least half of our Members, which is 138.

Mr Speaker, I want to humbly submit that you know what to do as we indicated. The number that I put previously when I made the application

was 77, and I still stand by it. If the Clerk or you direct it otherwise and there is a different number, I will respect your decision.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, sometimes we know the procedure, but deliberately, we want to put out the wrong impression. We have two types of quorums. We have a quorum for commencement and a quorum for decision. Now, any time the attention of the Speaker is drawn to the absence of a quorum, the Speaker takes advice from the Clerk. If we do not have the quorum, we ring the bell for 10 minutes, and then the other consequential procedures follow.

So, when you made the application, in fairness, I told you your application was premature. You have been in this House for five years, and for all those years, you have been in Leadership. Advise me on a single instance where a Business Statement is adopted by a vote.

Hon Members, when you know the truth, let us go by it. Let us not set a bad precedent. To quote the Minority Leader, “whether it is 20 or 30 years, the tables may turn”. I always take that aspect of his statement very seriously. So today, do not consider where you are sitting and say a Business Statement should be adopted by way of a vote. Hon Members, the truth is only one. There are Seniors in this House who attest to the fact that we do not adopt a Business Statement by way of a vote.

So, Hon Members, let us help with issues. Where there is no problem, let us not create one. So the ruling is that Business Statements are not adopted by

way of a vote. On this note, the Business Statement as presented is hereby adopted. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Hon Members, before we proceed, let me indicate that on the issue raised by the Minority Leader, he called on me not to make a ruling. And I intend not to make a ruling.

5:39 p.m.

However, the Speaker will be here to make a comment on the issue. But I will want to state clearly by way of advice to all of us that when a procedure is set down for a right to be exercised, it is that procedure that will have to be followed in exercising the right. Hon Members, when Motions are filed, the Motion is supposed to be admitted. It must pass the admissibility test. After the Motion is admitted, it is programmed on the *Order Paper*. Until and unless that Motion is programmed on the *Order Paper*, it cannot be debated. Hon Members, we cannot pass through the backdoor to do what is yet to be admitted. This is not a ruling, but is by way of advice to all of us, that a procedure is there to guide all of us. On that note, I will defer any further comments to the Speaker.

Hon Majority Leader, let me announce the presence of students from American Cooperative School. They are led by Acheampong Semebour Edward, headmaster, and they are from Effiduase Asokore. They 117 in number. Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome them. May you have a fruitful stay in the Parliament of Republic of the Ghana.

[Students of American Cooperative School were acknowledged]

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I crave your indulgence to vary the order of Business and then do some Public Business. We have spent three hours already, three hours that should have been meant for Public Business, we have spent it debating the Business Statement. So, let us do some Public Business. Mr Speaker permit me to invite you to vary the order of Business so that the Minister for Education can lay item 10(a).

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we do not have any difficulty. It can be laid.

Mr Speaker, issues concerning the Minister for Education, normally—Their people are now leaving the Chamber after being whipped to come and vote on the Business Statement. They are disappointed. They are leaving the Chamber, but the Minister for Education can lay the Papers.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, at the commencement of Public Business, the item numbered 10(a), Presentation and First reading of Bills.

BILL — FIRST READING

Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology Bill, 2025.

AN ACT to establish the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi, and to provide for related matters.

Presented by the Minister for Education (Mr Haruna Iddrisu). Read the First time; referred to the Committee on Education and the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, again, I seek your indulgence to vary the order of Business and take some two clauses of the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin — rose —

Mr Speaker, the agreement at Conclave was that the Minister for Energy and Green Transition is unavoidably absent. We may not take his Question. That was the agreement at Conclave. Mr Speaker is a witness to that agreement. That was the agreement at Conclave. So, in the absence of the Minister for Energy and Green Transition, I am urging that we take the Consideration Stage of the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think we can go ahead with that, considering the fact that the Hon Majority Leader has changed his tone from the time he was presenting the Business Statement. So, we can go ahead. *[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Hon Members, Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill 2025 at Consideration Stage.

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE
Ghana Scholarships Authority
Bill, 2025

[Resumption of Consideration from 06/11/2025]

Mr Eric Edem Agbana *on behalf of Chairperson of the Committee:* Mr Speaker, I beg to move, paragraph (i), *delete and insert* the following—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes,

Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, we were just told that we should comply with our Rules. Where is the Chairperson of the Committee? Mr Speaker, we need to know where the Chairperson of the Committee is.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader, they are asking of the absence of the—

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we noted that the Chairperson of the Committee on Education is on official duties outside of the jurisdiction, therefore, by our Rules, a Member of the Committee may be permitted to lead the discussions on behalf of the Committee.

Mr Speaker, we plead that you permit Mr Eric Edem Agbana, the Hon Member for Ketu North. He is a Member of the Committee. He is able and capable of leading the—We did that yesterday, Mr Speaker.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think we will not have any difficulty with Mr Agbana.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, as indicated, the Speaker is here to take the Chair. Hon Members, I also indicated that he has his comment on the issue raised by the Hon Minority Leader. We will have to defer the consideration of the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025.

5:47 p.m. — [THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN THE CHAIR]

5:49 p.m.

**FORMAL COMMUNICATION BY
THE SPEAKER**

The Speaker: I patiently observed and listened to you spend considerable time debating a report of the Business Committee. I had so many things to do, but I was compelled to leave that and come to clarify some issues, particularly, what led to the long discussion. I thought it was not necessary at all. We will not suspend the consideration of the Bill. After my submissions, we will go on with the consideration of the Bill.

Let me say, Hon Members, yesterday I returned a proposed Motion paper submitted by the Hon Minority Leader, Osahen Alexander Afenyo-Markin to the Clerk in accordance with Order 102 (3) of the Standing Orders of Parliament, which according to the Order, is to be submitted to me, as stated in Order 102(4), as being inadmissible. As required

by Order 102 (4) of the Standing Orders, I provided reasons on the face of the proposed Motion paper for my refusal to admit the Motion. I have this afternoon been compelled by what has gone on, in the course of your attempt to adopt the report of the Business Committee, and I am to provide my reasons to Plenary as part of my efforts to ensure full disclosure.

This, as you all know, is an administrative function. It is not something that should be done on the floor of the House. But with the way the deliberations have gone on, it has left not only Members, but our constituents a bit unclear about how we conduct things in the House. So, this is an attempt to clarify the issue and to bring finality to the matter raised by the Hon Minority Leader.

Hon Members, The Clerk-to-Parliament received a proposed Motion on 28th October, 2025. As I said, it is a proposed Motion and so it is couched in the form of a motion by the Hon Minority Leader as required by the Standing Orders. It was forwarded to my office the same day, that is 28th October, 2025. The secretariat at my office received it and it was later transmitted to me. It was now my duty to administratively consider the admissibility or otherwise of the Motion. In considering the admissibility of the Motion, I was guided by the provisions of the 1992 Constitution, the Standing Orders of the House, and precedence of parliamentary practice.

Hon Members, a Motion as defined in Order 6 of the Standing Orders of this House is a proposal made by a Member

of Parliament or a Committee to do something or “order something to be done or express an opinion concerning some matter;”. Standing Orders 102 and 103 vest discretionary powers in the Speaker to determine whether a Motion is admissible or not. In exercising this power, the Speaker must be guided by provisions as stated in Order 103 of the Standing Orders to either direct that the Motion be printed or the Motion be returned as inadmissible.

Hon Members, I have considered deeply the proposed Motion. I considered the text and I concluded that there was no basis for me to exercise the discretion to admit the Motion. I have a copy of the proposed Motion here. The Motion suggest that Parliament, as an Arm of State, stays its hand until another coordinate Arm of State takes action on a matter pending before it even when there is no definite time for that Arm of State to take the action.

I find this suggestion constitutionally and procedurally unsustainable. Article 144(1) of the 1992 Constitution gives Parliament a clear and continuing duty to consider a president’s nomination for Chief Justice. That duty is not conditional on events elsewhere. There is no constitutional or Standing Order basis for Parliament to halt the process simply because there are pending cases in court. Should I accept that argument, it would mean that any litigant could hold Parliament hostage, that is, file a case and freeze the work of Parliament and its Committees. That would undermine the concept of separation of powers and paralyse the constitutional machinery for filling, for example in this particular case, key offices of state.

Hon Members, I am very mindful of Article 2 of the 1992 Constitution, especially clause 2 of Article 2, which vests in the Supreme Court, powers to make orders and give such directions as it may consider appropriate, for giving effect to the declarations it has made. This article clearly states that, should there be any unconstitutionality regarding the removal of Her Ladyship Justice Torkonoo, the Court is vested with the power to so declare and make all necessary orders needed to restore the status quo.

5:59 p.m.

To that end, I am of the view that courts can continue to hear whatever matters are pending before them, but until there is an injunctive order, Parliament's authority remains intact. Judicial independence should not mean legislative paralysis. *[Hear! Hear!]*

In any case, I have consistently questioned whether the Supreme Court could use its injunctive relief to stratify the work of another arm of state. Is that the purpose of that relief? Hon Members, procedurally, I am also mindful of Order 103(f), which suggests that, a Motion shall not,

“(f) be the subject matter of an action on which a judicial decision is pending [40] in such a way as may, in the opinion of the Speaker, prejudice the interest of parties to the action;”

I have considered the provisions on admissibility of a Motion and I submit that the proposed Motion is out of order.

As I have already indicated, I am convinced that the Supreme Court is vested with adequate powers to reverse any action should they deem them unconstitutional. I have discussed this matter with the Minority Leader, who was bent on the Motion being admitted. It is not that I am just saying them now. But he gave me notice that he would definitely air his views on the Floor. I think that is why, as the Majority Leader said, even though you were discussing football, he brought in *ampe*. *[Laughter]*

In summary, Hon Members, the major point of this ruling is that the Motion is inadmissible and the same has been returned to the sponsor, the Minority Leader, Osahen Alexander Afenyo-Markin, as stated clearly by our Standing Orders.

I thank you all for your attention.
[Hear! Hear!]

Minority Leader, do you want to have another bite?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Respectfully, Mr Speaker, I would want with your leave to respond to a matter because of *Hansard*. We have reputational issues here. There are matters that perhaps you may not be in the know. For the sake of tomorrow, I believe that I must not be denied the opportunity to make this point known for *Hansard* because points have been made by you, added to your ruling, and it has gone into *Hansard*.

Mr Speaker, with respect, as you rightly stated, we filed this Motion on the set date. We were very vigilant enough.

We followed it to the Clerk's office and ensured the same had been transmitted. Mr Speaker, days passed. The Clerk communicated to me that my Motion cannot be traced. Yesterday, I followed up again because I know that he who comes to equity, must do equity, and must be vigilant. Equity has never favoured the indolent. So, I did not want to sleep on my rights.

I followed up again at Conclave, and I asked the Clerk to Parliament, has my Motion had any decision, so that the Caucus can know what step to take in accordance with our Rules? He then told me that Mr Speaker asked him to now procure a copy of the Motion from me because what was submitted could not be found. Mr Speaker, this is the truth and is indivisible. I then procured my copy because I kept a copy in my file. Then he later said he had sent for his copy because he also kept a copy. I did not allow him to come alone; I walked with him all the way to your office to make sure that the copy had been duly submitted, which you duly received.

Mr Speaker, I did not receive any communication until three—the time is here, and sometimes people would want to do things, and if you are not careful, you would lose your reputation. Mr Speaker, with respect, it is here.

[Hon Minority Leader read the time from his mobile phone]

Mr Speaker, the time is 16:32 p.m. that is 4:32 p.m. After we had raised the matter, your Minutes was sent to me via WhatsApp. Mr Speaker, I am a student

of this House. I would not do anything to embarrass myself. If I am not sure, I would not do it, and I would not seek to embarrass you or embarrass my Caucus. I do not want *Hansard* to record me as having acted in bad faith.

Mr Speaker, we filed this notice long ago. There is vetting on Monday, and we do not sit on Mondays. What other time would we have as a Caucus to air our views? Even now, your response has not been officially communicated to us. We do not have it.

Mr Speaker, I would speak the truth on this matter, and I would not want any impression to be created that I did something wrong. We do not have it. Mr Speaker, it is now that you have, with respect, read out in public your reasoning. We would pick it. What time again do we have to file another process to air our views?

But, Mr Speaker, this is Parliament, we would respect it. We even attached our written submission. That was how transparent we were. We did not just send a lame application. We attached a written submission with all the authorities, including the latest authority in this House, where the Majority Leader argued that Nana Boakye's process at the Supreme Court, which process was seeking some declaratory reliefs, should stop this House. And the First Deputy Speaker ruled in his favour upholding his application.

You may recall, Mr Speaker, that I came to you with an appeal, and you admitted my appeal, and a Motion for

review was filed. Mr Speaker, the Motion for review is still in today's *Order Paper*. It states: "That pursuant to Order 127 of the Standing Orders..."—

Mr Ayariga — *rose* —

The Speaker: Just a minute—

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Normally, he can have his right to speak after me. Mr Speaker, this point of order, I do not have a problem. He can speak.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker—

The Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, just a minute. Minority Leader, I have given you all the space to speak because you raised an issue about it. There are some matters I raised which may affect your integrity. That is why I gave you the space.

Now, you stated something which ignited the immediate reaction of the Majority Leader, and he stood on his feet. I signaled to him that he should allow you to land. But it seems the issue he wants to raise is so critical, and he was drawing my attention.

So, I just wanted you to hold your breath for him to do so and let me rule, please.

Hon Majority Leader?

6:09 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, he filed a Motion. You took a decision on the Motion. You transmitted the decision to

him. Whether it is hard copy or electronically, he has admitted that he has received your communication. You followed through and came to this House and communicated the decision. When he said you should give him permission to say some things because it had to do with integrity and credibility, we indulged him. Even my Chief Whip urged me to object. I said, no because he was raising administrative issues so, let us have that clarification. But he is now going beyond that and litigating your decision. He is arguing points of law in relation to your decision. He knows what our rules say. If the Minority Leader wants to challenge the decision of the Speaker, he knows how to do so. So, please, he knows the right thing. He may not be happy with the outcome, but this is not the procedure. He has raised the administrative issues. I think he has exhausted those ones. He has no right immediately to start arguing against the substance of the ruling of the Speaker. That will not be allowed.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, the beauty of our engagement here is the unfettered opportunity as the rules will permit us to air our views. So, I respect what the Majority Leader said. However, I submit that he misunderstood the point I was making.

Mr Speaker, clearly, I was on the point where I was drawing attention to the fact that at all material times, where dissatisfied, I had followed due process, including the very subject matter of your

ruling. The Majority Leader had objected on same ground that a matter was before court and the First Deputy Speaker had ruled in his favour. When I was dissatisfied, I filed an appeal before you, which you admitted, and that appeal has been pending since 5th of March. It is listed in today's *Order Paper* as Motion 15 which reads:

“That pursuant to Order 127 of the Standing Orders, the Rt Hon Speaker reviews the ruling of the First Deputy Speaker on 5th March, 2025 sustaining the preliminary objection raised by Hon Majority Leader, Mr Mahama Ayariga, against moving the Private Members' Motion listed as item number 16 on page 6 of the Order Paper for Wednesday, 5th March, 2025 and same captured in the Official Report of the House for the said date”.

Mr Speaker, perhaps if the space had permitted for us to determine this review application, maybe the approach—

The Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you are now going far beyond bounds. You know the tools of filibustering and the tool of playing to the gallery. I think this is what you are now employing, and I want to stop you at that. I do not want you to go beyond that. But clearly, I allowed this to happen because you took responsibility for the Motion, and you personally came to me. But on the face of the Motion, the sponsors of the Motion are Mr Anyimadu-Antwi, Member of Parliament (MP) for Asante Akim Central; Mr John Darko, MP for

Suame; Ms Gloria Owusu, MP for Trobu; Ms Damata Ama Appianimaa Salam, MP for Afigya Kwabre South; Mr Alhassan Tampuli Sulemana, MP for Gushegu; and Mr Kwabena Boateng, MP for Ejisu. But because you came personally to take responsibility for the Motion, that is why I addressed you. But the records show that when I minuted to the Clerk, because they have this on record, they had to convey it to the sponsors, and they have brought me documentary evidence, which is here with me now. Again, the Motion that came to me is the Motion paper with no attachment of any submissions.

Please, these are administrative matters, and I am not to bring them to the House. But because you brought the matter to the fore in plenary session, I am compelled to do so. Let us end it here, because you can always trace and trail submissions of documents through the administrative processes. There is no document that is received by my office that is not noted in the records of the Secretariat, and copies of the document kept in the Secretariat. We have all. So, there is no way that a Motion paper will pass through my Secretariat, come to me and I minute, and then it cannot be traced. It is not done, because we have copies there, and even the minutes that are put on the paper are also captured in the records of my Secretariat. So, if Hon Members are not aware, you can easily trace these records. Nobody can tell you that they cannot trace the records. They are available.

And by my training, I keep records. I know, one day when I am not here, some

people may raise some issues. And all those holding responsibilities must be prepared to answer. Whether in 10 or 20 years, allegations can be made against you and you need to defend yourself. You need to have records. Do not just leave them and go, and when you are called upon, you are found wanting, because you are naked. So, I have all this. Let us move on to the Motion that was referred to earlier, for us to continue with the consideration of the Bill, please.

Hon Members, we go to page 7, the item numbered 17 of the *Order Paper*. Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025 at the Consideration Stage.

Hon Members, on the *Order Paper*, I see that on 17(i), which deals with clause 3. If that is where you have got to, then I will call on the Chairman of the Committee to move the Motion for amendment of that clause.

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025

*[Resumption of Consideration from
Column 81]*

Clause 1 — Functions of the
Authority

Mr Eric Edem Agbana *on behalf of
the Chairman of the Committee:*
Thank you, Mr Speaker. I beg to move
that—

The Speaker: Are you the Chairman
of the Committee?

Mr Eric Agbana: Mr Speaker, the
Chairperson is unavoidably absent and
permission has been sought for me—

The Speaker: Permission has been
sought for you and it was granted by
my—

Yes, First Deputy Speaker?

Mr Ahiafor: Yes, Mr Speaker, all
the clauses here were deferred. We have
done everything but clauses 3, 4 and 5
which were deferred, so we are not
starting from clause 3. We should move
to clause 4, 5, 6 and onwards. We have
done everything but these are only
deferred clauses.

The Speaker: Exactly. So, I asked
for the amendment on clause 3 as
proposed to be moved, but because he
stood up and I recognise that he is not the
Chairman—

Mr Ahiafor: Mr Speaker, while I
was in the Chair, there was an indication
that the Chairman is outside the country
attending to official duties at UNESCO,
in particular. So, both Sides agreed that
in the absence of the Chairman, a
member of the Committee could move
the Motion for the amendments. Hence,
Mr Edem Agbana is moving the
amendments as a member of the
Committee.

The Speaker: It is just that it is
procedural because I said Chairman of
the Committee, and he stood up. But I
did not get this explanation. So, my good
Son, you may do so once you have the
leave of the Speaker.

Clause 3 — Functions of the Authority

Mr Agbana: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I beg to move, paragraph I, *delete* and *insert* the following:

“(i)award foreign scholarship for a programme including skills upgrading that is not wholly available in the country;”

The Speaker: Hon Members, Motion is moved, and it is for the consideration of the House.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I want to make a counter-proposal to this particular amendment. If you look at the original—

The Speaker: Hon Member, you want to plead to put a counter-proposal or you want to propose further amendment?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: I want to propose further amendment. Mr Speaker, thank you for the guidance.

I make reference to the intent of the Bill in ensuring that scholarship granted are for programmes that are not wholly available in Ghana. So, in the instance where this amendment is seeking to award foreign scholarships for programmes including skills upgrading that is not wholly, I believe that the word “not

wholly” is very subjective and difficult to determine, because what constitutes “not wholly” available in Ghana? So, I think that the “not wholly” should be deleted so that we stick to skills and a new addition to the effect that it should be “a programme including skills upgrading that is not available in Ghana”.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Do I give to my Deputy? I think that the Hon Minister should have a bite before.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I urge that the last speaker be persuaded to abandon his amendment. The Committee of Vice Chancellors led by the Vice Chancellor for the University of Ghana drew my attention that they have what they call “split site degrees” where part of the programme is taken in their country and a part abroad. This is what informed this proposition.

One may be doing a programme where they have to spend one or two years in Ghana and spend another one or two years abroad in order to complete the programme. If we restrict it to only what is not available in Ghana, it may be difficult for that category of students. That is why the Committee was persuaded to reword the rendition.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: You are not persuaded?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: No, Mr Speaker.

I think the rendition does not give that impression, because if you say “not wholly available” in Ghana, it means that the course is not available in Ghana. But when—*[Interruption]*. Please, allow me to make my point. From his explanation, it is speaking to cross country programmes. That is different from a programme that is—If you say a programme is not available, it means that that programme cannot be found in this country. That is what I understand by not available in Ghana. That is why I believe that when it comes to scholarship that is being awarded to students, we need to take a decision whether it should be granted only for courses not available in Ghana. If we intend to make courses that are partially available in Ghana or the rendition that is provided in the amendment, it lacks clarity, and it will be difficult for anybody to understand and give this as a meaning to scholarship that is not available in Ghana. So, I am not convinced with that.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Let me listen to Mr Mahama Shaibu.

Mr Shaibu Mahama: I am most grateful, Mr Speaker.

I would want to join the Hon Minister for Education in urging my Brother to abandon his further amendment. The original rendition was “award foreign scholarships for only programmes that are not available in the country”.

Mr Speaker, over the years, we realised in the 1980s where with the

Dentistry programme, one would do two or three years in Ghana, then you continue in England, there are programmes, that need an upgrade even after you have completed the programme in Ghana. Skills upgrading, new programmes have come into play, including IT and artificial intelligence. It is possible that universities may mount such programmes, but they are not exhaustive, so if one needs an upgrade, it means that they have to leave the shores of Ghana to pursue that. So, the original rendition that clearly bans programmes that are only available here do not allow members to do an upgrade of it outside. That is the reason this new rendition now says, “programmes, including skills upgrading, that is not wholly available”. It may be available all right, but it does not end here. So, I urge my good Friend to abandon his further amendment to what already exists.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Ahiafor: Mr Speaker, thank you for giving me the opportunity to persuade my Hon Member.

The original rendition in clause 3(i) is “award foreign scholarships for only programmes that are not available in the country”, and our attention has been drawn to the fact that currently, there is a programme called Split Site, in which parts will be offered in the country and parts will be offered outside the country. Therefore, if we limit the award of scholarships to only programmes not offered in the country, it means we will be denying the category of people admitted for that Split Site programme.

6:29 p.m.

So, in view of that, it is necessary to amend the rendition to cover those people who would study courses that are not wholly in the country. That was what informed this particular rendition. If we leave the old rendition, then it means the category of people who would be involved in the split side programme would not have the opportunity to be given a scholarship.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member for Kwadaso?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I remember when we met at Peduase to look at this Bill, this matter came up, and I remember I raised the point that if we go by the original rendition, we are going to deny others from enjoying the scholarship. I remember it was not agreed on. I am happy that it has now found favour before the Committee. So I support the current rendition.

I used to be the CEO for the National Accreditation Board, now Ghana Tertiary Education Commission (GTEC), and there are some programmes that we may run in this country and elsewhere, but in terms of the infrastructure, they might be enhanced or at an advanced stage out there than here. So, if we say that we are not going to allow them to benefit, then it is going to be discriminatory.

I also want to urge our Colleagues that this current rendition best supports the intention of the Bill and does not exclude others who are pursuing the programme from enjoying the Scholarship.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Well, Hon Members, between “wholly available” and “fully pursued”, which is preferable, that rendition has been given to me too. “That is not fully pursued in the country”, and then “that is not fully available in the country”. Which one is preferable? It is a matter of policy.

Hon Minister?

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I was consulting with the First Deputy Speaker, who is a modern draft person, to help see if I can get the words “split side programmes”. Those are the words the Vice Chancellor of the University of Ghana, Prof Nana Aba, shared with me, and she provided further elucidation on what that meant.

“Fully pursued”, Mr Speaker, will not do any harm, but maybe we could have said “award foreign scholarships for a programme including split side programmes and skills upgrading that is not fully pursued”. I will go for that, but I will bring in the expression “split side”.

Mr Speaker, just as you are rightly guiding us, for instance, she studied medicine and studied a particular type of medicine. Today, she may need the artificial application of medicine. In dealing with the same enterprise of medicine, that artificial intelligence leg may not be available. I will be guided by your words, to use “fully pursued”, but I will still import the words “split side programmes”. And then we define “split side programme” in the interpretation as a technical word.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, please.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Guided by what you said, I believe that programmes are mostly run.

So, I would have suggested “award foreign scholarship for a programme including skills upgrading that is not fully run in the country”.

The Speaker: So, you would prefer “run”, not “pursued”.

Drafting is a very difficult subject, and you know, language matters. I have been a former Minister for Health. I am aware that even our country also benefits from that. Sometimes, some countries in the study of medicine do not have the level of clinicals that we do here. So they study the Biological Sciences and the rest, and bring their students to Ghana to come and continue with the clinical.

So, we have those things happening, particularly with modernisation, and the introduction of new technology, for example, robotics, AI, and the rest. So we have those split things; the idea is good. It is well accepted by all. But it is an appropriate wording that we are now trying to build consensus on. So, I got this, and I want to put a question. “Award foreign scholarship for a split programme including skills upgrading that is not fully run in the country”. Is it acceptable? *[Pause]*

Yes, I would just advise that the draft person will put it in the appropriate

words. But definitely, what she is trying to do is to make it two, not one sentence. But separate the programme from the skills so that you have “award foreign scholarships for split programmes not fully run in the country”, which will be different. And another “for skills upgrading, not fully run in the country”. That is what she is trying to do.

But I will put the question on the main idea, which is accepted. And the rule now is that after we finish the Consideration Stage, the whole Bill will be compiled and brought to us before we go to the Third Reading. So, when it comes to us, we will see how it has been captured. If there is a need for us to do a Second Consideration, then we will do so.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko — *rose*—

The Speaker: Hon Member, after I have taken the vote? Yes, go ahead.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: On the (k) of clause 3, before you put the question on the entirety of clause 3, I just want to find out—It says “ensure effective decentralisation of the operations of the authority to the districts and regions of the country”.

I am wondering why we are doing the decentralisation to both districts and regions. I believe if it is to the districts, we should leave it at the districts. And if we want to do it for the regions, we do the decentralisation to the regions.

6:39 p.m.

But when we talk about decentralising to both districts and regions of the country, I think there is a problem to that. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Member, actually your proposal is not on the *Order Paper*, and therefore I am finding it difficult to capture it as you just *moved*. As I indicated early on, if there is a need for us to do a Second Consideration, when it is compiled and submitted to Members, you may come back so that we can move.

Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I believe my Hon Colleague should re-read paragraph (k). Mr Speaker, I beg to quote, “Ensure effective decentralisation of the operations of the authority to the district and regions of the country.” I do not see any problem with it. The Scholarship Secretariat is normally housed in Accra, so what this is suggesting is that they should seek to decentralise their operations. By Ghanaian Constitution and law, when we are decentralising, where do you decentralise to? Either a Regional Coordinating Council or a District Coordinating Council. We do not want them to just be in Accra. If one is an applicant from Sefwi Bodi, and can go to your Regional Coordinating Council to seek a government scholarship, must the person necessarily come to Accra?

Mr Speaker, this is futuristic to ensure effective decentralisation of the operation. When it is established, then they can do that. Thank you.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Scholarship Secretariat as it is now, their operations are actually decentralised. They have committees at the District Assemblies that are interviewing applicants. It is already decentralised. Decentralisation simply means their operations is not centralised at the national level. So, we can have them at the regional level, the district level, and even zonal basis. My Hon Brother should abandon his position so we can make progress in this matter.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I think these are matters we can discuss with him. As I indicated early on. He may not be persuaded to come back so that we can go ahead.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 3 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr Agbana on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*, subclause (1), paragraph (b), add the following new subparagraph, “Ministry responsible for Gender;”

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, under clause 4, we are looking at the governing body of the Authority. Already under (b), we have Ministers for Education, Ministers for Finance, Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment, Minister for Youth Empowerment and Development, and we have Ministry of Foreign Affairs. Over here, on one governing board, you

have about five Ministers already represented on the board. I just want to understand how and why we think the Ministry for Gender, Children and Social Protection should also be added to make it six. I believe that we should not be encouraging more Ministry representatives on boards like these, rather than looking at more technical people on to the representation of the board. I think the already existing Ministers are adequate to cater for concerns on the issues of gender. So, I am proposing that this be abandoned. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we should also be cautious of the fact that the concept we are practising is that the Government is usually ultimately held responsible. If we talk about technical people handling these matters, whilst you, the Member of Parliament, is being blamed on the ground, when you have no hand in it, or the Government is not the one having the controlling power. You see that that would be “stray bullets”. If you have the Ministers who are to assist the President, who is the one given the constitutional mandate to house the Executive authority to implement these policies, their ultimate responsibility should always be with that Executive. Then we can hold them to account, and that is the duty of Parliament. But definitely the inclusion of Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection is to make sure that there will always be some gender consideration in this matter, not only on the board, but in the awards of the scholarship, so that our fairer side are not marginalised in this matter. So, I

think the gender thing is quite appropriate.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, admittedly to your guidance, but that will make the composition even (12), because already if you check what we had, that was an 11-member board. So, when we bring the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection, it will make it 12 members.

The Speaker: That is a genuine concern. That is even—and for decision-taking, unless you do something else, it could be a deadlock.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am sure the Committee has taken note of it. There will be one additional nomination to the governing board. Mr Speaker, if you would recall, after the Second Reading, there was an uproar by Civil Society groups in education who were making a good case that they be represented on the board in order to allow for transparency. We may be proposing a member of the Civil Society group in education; we will nominate one of them to serve on the board. So, we may bring the number to 13, but that is left to the Committee.

The Speaker: Yes, actually, the proposals are there in the amendments.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr Agbana on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, subclause (1),

after paragraph (d), insert the following new paragraph:

“One representative of the Student Loan Trust Fund not below the rank of a Director, nominated by the Governing body of Student Loan Trust Fund;”

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I support the present amendment except to propose a further amendment to say that instead of one representative, we should indicate specifically that it should be the CEO of the Student Loan Trust Fund so that we are very clear. It should be the CEO of the Student Loan Trust Fund who should be nominated by the governing body of Student Loan Trust Fund to serve—

The Speaker: Why? Why do you want to take that thing from the students in deciding who should represent them? Why do you want to take it away?

6:49 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, because the Student Loan Trust Fund is also set up to offer financial assistance. But we believe that the administrative head, who is the Chief Executive Officer (CEO), will better serve their interests on the Scholarship Board.

The Speaker: I am not too sure about that, because loans are different from scholarships.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, yes, I agree. But it is for a purpose. Secondly, instead of saying “one representative”, it

should be “A representative of the Student Loan Trust Fund”. Subsequently, where we are using one, I believe that it should be “a”. I think that is the drafting style that we use.

The Speaker: That is correct. You are right in that direction. Let us consider the first leg of his submissions. Yes, Hon Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, it seems he has abandoned his point. Because “one representative of the Student Loan Trust Fund, not below the rank of a director.” If his proposal is anything to go by, I do not think the CEO is below the rank of a director. No, he said we should state that it should be the CEO, but if the rendition is to be “not below the rank of a director”, the CEO is not below the rank of a director. So, what would be the reason? The CEO would be a political appointee. So, if we are looking for a director to be a representative of the Scholarship Secretariat, the way it stands is all right.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Ministers who are to be represented are also political appointees. So, I will disengage, but I want to propose that where we use the phrase “one representative” – the drafters know that, ordinarily we use “a representative”.

The Speaker: Actually, the drafters say we do not use “a”, we use “one”, because all the representatives are “a representative”. But to make sure that they do not go beyond that, and stay to one, we use “one representative”.

Mr Dafeamekpor: I am guided.

Question put and amendment agreed to

The Speaker: We will go to page 8 (iv) clause 4.

Mr Agbana: Amendment proposed, Subclause (1), after paragraph (f), *delete* “three” and *insert* “two”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

The Speaker: The final amendment to clause 4.

Mr Agbana: Amendment proposed, Subclause (1), *insert* the following new paragraph: “one representative of civil society nominated by the Minister”

The Speaker: Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know if the acting Chairperson can throw more light. Because if he says “one representative of civil society”, it is not too clear. Civil society in what? Can he clarify that? — Mr Speaker, the Hon First Deputy Speaker is guiding me here. “One representative of civil society in education nominated by the Minister”. The question is, why must a person be nominated by the Minister? Can the civil society organisation not also nominate their own person? Why should it be done by the Minister?

The Speaker: Any explanation?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, the first correction that he did is exactly what we had proposed. So, “one representative of civil society in education nominated by the Minister”. Indeed, we recognise that there are many civil society organisations, and if we leave that to just say nominated by themselves, putting themselves together becomes a problem. The Ministry coordinates the various civil society organisations in education, so they will be in a better position to nominate somebody from one of the organisations.

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. There is the Ghana National Education Campaign Coalition (GNECC), which is a civil society network, duly recognised. It is the umbrella body for all civil society organisations that are into education. I know this for a fact because I have worked with them in the past. Mr Speaker, we may be looking at couching the rendition to reflect the network. So, my proposed amendment is “one representative of the civil society network on education nominated by the Coalition,” All of them have been appointed by the President, right? So “nominated by the Coalition” would be better, rather than the Minister. Mr Speaker, let me make my proposal a bit clearer. “One representative of the civil society network on education, nominated by the Coalition in consultation with the Minister.”

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we also have Ghana National Education Campaign Coalition (GNECC). [**Some Hon Members:** It is the same thing] Oh,

I see. But the fear is that these coalitions, often break up. As we speak, Parliament is running itself into some problems, especially where we have legislated in the years before, using, for instance, the Ghana Bar Association. We also have Ghana Law Society of which I am the founding president and member. *[Uproar]* Mr Speaker, you have to ask my members. One would discover that in this House, since 2017, we have not enacted legislation specifically mentioning Ghana Bar Association. So, we are trying to avoid specifically mentioning societies in our legislation. As we speak, I am in court —

The Speaker: Hon Member, we do not need to split hairs over this. We are a free society; therefore, we want to open up to the best. It is not every person in the civil society that is a member of the Coalition. We have some good materials who are not members of that Coalition. So, experience has shown that we do not limit or put fetters in the way of our enjoyment of the freedoms that are guaranteed under the 1992 Constitution. So, I agree that we should talk about “one representative of civil society in education, nominated by the Minister”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

6:59 p.m.

When I check the number in terms of the constitution of the Board, best practices have shown that normally, you have to make sure that the numbers are

odd. If my mathematics is right, I see that the numbers may be an even number. So, it would be appropriate that we rather take one out or we add one so that we would be able to have an odd number, which is in consonance with best practices as far as governing boards are concerned.

The Speaker: Let me put a question on — well, yes, it is dealing with clause 4. You are right. Because this was early on raised by Prof; I think he is not there again. But the indication was that we are going to add some more numbers. But what we have added again has taken it to an even number. So, the point that he has raised is right. We have to address that.

So, we would move on, and then later on, maybe, during the Second Consideration of the Bill—I would put the question on clause 4, when we are doing the Second Consideration of the Bill, then we would consider that issue. The number is 13.

Mr Richard Gyan-Mensah: Clause 4 cures what was raised. The introduction of “civil society” makes the number 13.

The Speaker: Hon Members, let us move on. You can cross-check later. If they need to do a Second Consideration, we would do that.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the proposal is that we should add the National Union of Ghana Students (NUGS) to the Board.

The Speaker: I beg you, do not react.

Mr Dafeamekpor: So, we would come back. The Second Consideration would cure that. Thank you.

The Speaker: Go and consider it and make sure you are doing the right thing. It is very easy when we are doing the Third Reading. If it is settled, we would just put it in. There is no problem.

Clause 4 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 5 — Functions of the Board

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, I beg to move clause 5, paragraph (e), *delete* and *insert* the following: “(e) monitor the use of funds of the Authority”.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know why the Chairperson is taking out a Motion. So, we propose “monitor and accountability of the funds of the Authority”.

The Speaker: You monitor accountability?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I said monitor. The original rendition was “monitor and evaluate accountability of the funds of the Authority”. At the moment, the new proposal is “monitor the use of funds of the Authority.” But, Mr Speaker, at a point, there must be accountability so I was proposing — Alright. Mr Speaker, I have abandoned it, because on clause 5(f), accountability is mentioned.

The Speaker: Hon Members, there have been no further deliberations on this matter.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

We go to the next proposal on the amendment of clause 5.

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, clause 5, paragraph (f), *delete* and *insert* the following: “(f) ensure accountability in the management of the funds of the Authority; and”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

The Speaker: The next proposed amendment on clause 5.

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, clause 5, *insert* the following new paragraphs:

“(#) approve policies and guidelines for the award of scholarships”.

Question put and amendment agreed to

The Speaker: We would take the last proposed amendment, which is on 17(ix) on the *Order Paper*.

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, clause 5, *insert* the following new paragraphs:

“(#) provide strategic direction for the Authority”.

The Speaker: Do you provide direction ‘to’ or ‘for’ the Authority? “Provide strategic direction for the Authority”, or “provide strategic direction to the Authority”? The English masters?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think it should be ‘to’ the Authority, except that I want to seek clarification on what strategic direction is in this context. What does it mean if the Board is to give strategic direction to the Authority?

The Speaker: Actually, that is what I learned in English.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I am not a student of English, but of drafting. I think “for” is more appropriate than “to”.

The Speaker: Well, my consultant, the draft person says ‘to’ is more preferable. Now, you are still a student. You are allowed to contest your master in anyway. But the draft person says “...‘to’ the Authority”. This is because you are directing them as to what to do.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I yield.

7:09 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the further amendment is to *delete* ‘for’ and *insert* ‘to’.

So, the proposed amendment is “provide strategic direction to the authority.”

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I seek your guidance on the whole architecture of what the functions of the board is. I say so because I sense the drafting is giving day-to-day management activity to the board as well. Because when you check the functions of the Director General, the Director General has been given the mandate to lead the day-to-day administration of the agency.

But if you check clause 5(a) which states “review and consider applications for government scholarships”. Mr Speaker, this seems to me that we are giving the day-to-day administration of the agency to the board. And I would have wished that we *delete* clause 5(a), and allow the board to be given directives rather than going into the day-to-day administration of what the Scholarship Secretariat is supposed to be doing. And so, with your guidance, if the drafters will agree, then we can *delete* the “(a)” from it so that we do not allow the board to now go into the day-to-day administration of the agency. Thank you.

The Speaker: Well, this issue has been discussed many times. But the current rendition means that the work will actually be done by the Director General and the staff. It is the second one that we will need the board to review, so they will not be doing the day-to-day. You have many submissions, sectors and skills from all over. And so, they will have the opportunity to do the day-to-day by compiling everything and then taking a decision that this list is what qualifies

to be considered. But what the board will do is to review it. Do not forget you are here and definitely, there is pressure on you on some of these things. There are so many considerations that go into it.

And so, when you give —and I have confronted a number of people in this country who talk about protocol lists. Now I challenge any Ghanaian to go to any institution and see whether the technocrats do have any consideration also involving their interests. If that is the case, what prevents the people who are given the authority to make sure that we are all doing better from having a say in those decisions. There is nothing wrong with that. It is just that people have politicised and partisanship has come in and people are really not analysing the issues. You have all experienced them and you have seen it all over. They have the opportunity to decide who to employ; go and see the employment.

So, I think that the checks and balances should be there. Yes, but the person who has the ultimate responsibility should have the final say. There is nothing wrong with that. So, I think that will not even end it because after the board has done the revision, it goes further. And that is where we talk about situating the authority. Whether it should be under a sector, the Minister for Education, or it should go to the Office of Government Machinery. Those are also matters that you will be considering.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr John Darko: Thank you, Mr Speaker. As much as I agree with your

proposition, I believe that in situations where board members do this kind of work, we look at commissions instead of authorities. If you have a commission like Forestry Commission where board members more or less engage in day-to-day administration of the institution, then your argument, with the greatest of respect, will be well placed. But with respect, where it is an authority, where the functions of the board are supposed to be giving direction to management, I find it difficult to believe that reviewing and considering of application will be a duty of a board. But I just wanted to bring that to the attention of the Rt Hon Speaker. If it were a commission, I would wholly agree with you. But in this case, I just have a small doubt on it. But I will still defer to your good judgements, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: You formulate the policies and they implement. Now, when they do their work, at least there should be the opportunity for you to look at it to see whether it is in line with the policy. So, I agree with you that things like “consider applications” are not part of review. Because those things have already been done by the day-to-day administrators. They have considered the applications, gone through them, and brought the shortlists. And these applications will come from multilaterals, bilateral, charity organisations, various sectors, and you will consider those applications. And being guided by the policy, you will now compile. So, at least, there is nothing wrong with those who have formulated the policies to look at it again to see whether they are in line with the policies that they have

formulated and whether you are even going in accordance with the law. I do not think there is anything wrong with that one. And so, if it is for us to remove the word “consider applications”, I will agree with you on that one but with “review”, I think it is right.

Yes, First Deputy Speaker?

Mr Ahiafor: Mr Speaker, “day-to-day activity” is completely different from “review activity”. Review activity is a secondary activity. There must be a primary activity leading to the review activity. Therefore, the review cannot amount to day-to-day activity.

Mr Speaker, if you look at this particular law, there is a guideline and policy that must be followed by the Chief Executive in receiving the applications and determining whoever is qualified. If the Board does not review the applications received and determined by the Chief Executive, how would they be able to determine whether the Chief Executive has complied with the rules and regulations and the policies governing the award of scholarship? So, the Board, in reviewing the policy, must give consideration to those applications being reviewed. So, there is nothing wrong with the rendition. I state again that review is a secondary process.

The primary process is the day-to-day activity. He has the rudiment of the game to receive the applications, sieve the applications, determine those who are qualified and those who are not qualified in line with the guidelines and

the policies. We do not want to leave it like that, where there will be room for rumour of corruption, that someone is not qualified, but someone might have taken something and clear the person. That is why it is being subjected to another layer at the Board level, where the Board will have the opportunity to review the applications emanating from the Chief Executive. So, it is the work of the Chief Executive that will be reviewed by the Board.

7:19 p.m.

The Speaker: Yes, that is why I said the word “consider” is primary and that should not be included but as for “review”, it is secondary.

Yes, Hon Member for Walewale?

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I think that the sponsors of this Bill had a certain intention, and that can be deciphered from clause 10 of the Bill. Clause 10 of the Bill contemplates the establishment of committees within the board, comprising of members and non-members of the board. Of interest, is the assessment committee. There is a provision under clause 10 Mohammed Mohammed (4) which says that:

“Without limiting the subsection (1), the Board may establish the following committees:

- (a) the Assessment Committee;
- (b) the Monitoring and Evaluation Committee; and
- (c) the Finance Committee.”

Mr Speaker, I think that reading clause 10 in conjunction with clause 5, which provides the function of the board, there is that intention that the board may be engaged. Because that work of selection and assessment is not left to the CEO to determine. There is a board constituted for the purpose of determining whether or not applicants have qualified, and that decision of the subcommittee will come back to the board. The subcommittee is a subcommittee of the board. It is not a subcommittee of any institution. It is clearly stated that the board may establish committees consisting of members of the board or non-members or both to perform a function of the board. So, it is a committee of the board.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, in practice, you know it is just to make the work of the board easier at board meetings. So, you always have the CEO, the Director General, and the staff do the actual day-to-day work, before they send it to that subcommittee of the board, and they will go through it. Once the subcommittee gives no objection and accepts it, it becomes easier for the board. Because there is a lot of work for both the authority, the commission, and the board to do. And so that does not mean that the board itself is involved in what they do at that level.

I think that those of you who have worked in these situations have experienced it on a daily basis. We process a lot of applications here in Parliament which the Parliamentary Service works on. When you ask for employment, you can receive thousands

of applications. That cannot be done by a committee of the board. The daily consideration will be done by the technical staff who shortlists it, and a subcommittee of the Board looks at it. That way, it is easier, because many items come to the Board, and this will be just one of them, so they easily accept what comes from their subcommittee. But definitely that review is necessary for the board. I think so.

Hon Members, you make the decisions, but that is not here. I think he was just asking for my guidance. So let me put the question on the whole of clause 5.

Hon Members, the question is that—There is a further amendment to clause 5?

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, the amendment proposed is to *delete* paragraph (c) of clause 5, administer Government Scholarships, in the light of the discussion that has just transpired. And because we are saying that administrative work is purely supposed to be—If we take it out, it will not hurt anything, Mr Speaker.

I am arguing that—*[Interruption]*

The Speaker: Yes, I hear you. But who is administering what you are talking about? Is it the authority or the board?

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: The board.

The Speaker: No, that should be for the secretariat. So, Hon Members, it is

not on the *Order Paper*, but there is a proposed further amendment for us to *delete* paragraph (c).

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 5 as amended is ordered to stand part of the Bill.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we have come to the end of the consideration of the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025.

Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we have to reconsider the Long Title. Mr Speaker, this House for a long time—

The Speaker: Did you say reconsider?

Mr Dafeamekpor: We have to take a look at the Long Title.

The Speaker: We have to do the Long Title.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes.

The Speaker: When you say reconsider, it means—

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, so I will rephrase, Mr Speaker. Let me wait till you mention the long title, then I come in.

The Speaker: Hon Members, what he did was just to remind me that we have not considered the Long Title. So,

let me now put the question. Hon Members, Long Title of the Bill.

Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my humble position is that we do not legislate for any other country. We legislate for Ghana so, “Ghana” in the title is needless. It should be Scholarships Authority Bill, in this case. So that we take away ‘Ghana’.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: So, we will take away “Ghana” from Education Service and Revenue Authority, is that the situation?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I raised this matter about eight years ago on this Floor that—

The Speaker: So, we should take “Ghana” away everything that will come to the Floor now?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the venerable Kyei-Mensah-Bonsu told me. I referenced other legislation that we have used Ghana, and he said we have moved away from those early colonial days of legislation, and that once we do not legislate for any other country, it is needless to introduce the name of the country into the title of enactments that this House considers and passes. So, for a long time, we have not seen Ghana featuring in all the laws that we enacted, except the Ghana GoldBod Act, and the defense was that—Yes, I resisted on this Floor. So, I made a point that—

The Speaker: Hon Member, you are overruled. We have always been passing laws with Ghana. And in the case of scholarships, there are other scholarship schemes so, we want to be specific.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Well, Mr Speaker, for the records. I am of the humble view that “Ghana” in the Long Title is surplusage. It does not serve any purpose. But if the House is of a contrary opinion, let the record bear me out.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

7:29 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think the Hon Majority Chief Whip—

In the Ninth Parliament, we passed similar laws, with Ghana being part of it. The popular MahamaCares, which is the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, and the Ghana Road Maintenance Trust Fund, all had “Ghana” in them. So, if they are abandoning it, they should do the right thing.

The Speaker: Hon Member, when you go to Google and type in the Scholarships Authority Act, 2025, do you know the number of bills that pop up? So is it Ghana or Nigeria? But when you specifically put it Ghana Scholarships Authority Act, 2025, that is what will pop up. But if you just say Scholarships Authority Act 2025, a number will pop up, and now you have to go through all to know which one is for Ghana.

There is a good reason why you have to be specific.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I recall very well what the then Majority Leader said. He said—

The Speaker: Well, we are talking about today’s Majority Leaders. We are not talking about the then.

Mr Dafeamekpor: I agree with you, Mr Speaker, but the point was that if we were minded that we could do “National” instead of “Ghana”. We learn every day, so I am guided.

The Speaker: You have heard me say many times that we have not yet formed a nation. When we form a nation, and we are using “National”, I will accept it. Because merit is not what is happening; it is not meritocracy. When you form a nation, the main consideration is merit. Now you are still living in kingdoms, in regions, in ethnic groups, and in your religious minds. We have to do away with all that to form a nation. Then we have one vision.

Aspects are being implemented according to perspectives, not what we have now. I have been supported by our father, *Otumfour* and other great chiefs. Other intellectuals are also supportive in working towards at least consolidating and entrenching nationhood in this country.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, indeed, that is why we must begin to give the nomenclature to our legislation with the nation as an attempt to consolidate our coming together.

The Speaker: But it would not be only Ghana that will form a nation. There are other nations. So you cannot just use “nation”. It will refer to all the other nations, too.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we have—

The Speaker: Hon Member, you are completely out of order. *[Laughter]*

The Long Title ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Hon Members, I can now safely say we have come to the end of the Consideration Stage of the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill 2025.

Yes, Leadership. If not, I will proceed to adjourn the Sitting.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we have done more than five hours. We have a plethora of Questions unanswered, as well as Statements advertised. So may we direct that they be re-advertised for Tuesday so that we can expressly deal with them. I am sure today the sense of the House is that—

The Speaker: Sorry? Hon Members, First Deputy Speaker to take the chair.

7:33 p.m.—

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we were making the point that we have done more than five hours. There was a plethora of Questions unanswered, as well as Statements advertised for today. But given the sense of the House, today being Friday as well, we are in your hands, but we want to give an indication to the Table Office that the Questions that have not been answered today, as well as the Statements advertised to have been taken today, be posted to next Tuesday.

Fortuitously, the Deputy Minister for Energy and Green Transition is here. So, he is on notice to return on Tuesday to take these Questions. In addition to those that have been stated in the Business Statement to have been taken on Tuesday. Tuesday will be quite a heavy day, but we will be able to deal with it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you have a legitimate concern. But regarding the Questions to be answered on Tuesday, I will leave it to the Table Office because what we are trying to do now is to avoid a situation where the Questions will be slated, and it is not convenient for the Minister in question. They know the Ministers that they have communicated with to come and answer Questions on Tuesday. So, they should communicate with the Ministers who were to answer Questions today but could not make it. If they can be available on Tuesday, then they will schedule accordingly for the Questions to be answered.

Secondly, we have not done five hours, then there must be a Motion for an

adjournment. But before then, let me make this announcement.

Invitation to attend a three-day training programme for the leadership of Parliamentary Committees under the auspices of the Rt Hon Speaker of Parliament, Alban Sumana Kingsford Bagbin, and the Leadership of the House. The Parliamentary Training Institute (PTI) is organising a three-day capacity-building training programme for the leadership of Parliamentary Committees on the theme, “Strengthening Committee Leadership for Effective Parliamentary Oversight and Governance”.

The Programme is from Saturday 8th to Monday, 10th November, 2025. At Alisa Hotel, Ridge, Accra. The reporting date is on Friday, 7th November, 2025. Time, 9 a.m. to 4 p.m. daily. The training aims to improve the leadership and strategic management skills of Parliamentary Committee leadership, to increase the effectiveness of parliamentary oversight, committee coordination and operations, and to ensure the proper application of the rules within Committees.

Hon Members, thank you for your rapt attention.

Yes?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, on the small matter of notice, the Questions were in the name of the Minister for Energy and Green Transition, but he detailed his Deputy, who is a Member of Parliament, to be here. So we want to plead with you that there is no need for

the House to write again to the Minister to appear on Tuesday. We want him to be put on notice that on Tuesday, he should return to take the Questions. That is all that I am saying.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. So the Deputy is assuring us that the Minister will be available to provide Answers to those Questions.

7:39 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, having said this, may I move—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, let me hear Hon Second Deputy Minority Whip, then you can have the floor to move the Motion.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, I think that my Hon Colleague on the other Side, who is becoming *Killer ntua*, to wit: “Killer is not paying”, should engage. He cannot just be doing this without recourse to us, and then act as if that is consensus building. Mr Speaker, we are minded to take the Deputy Minister. We have not done five hours; we are willing to Sit.
[Interruption]

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the part that I disagree with the Hon Majority Chief Whip is to the effect that he cannot say that the Hon Minister for Energy and Green Transition should answer his Questions on Tuesday. Today, the Hon Majority Leader and the Chairperson of the Business Committee presented the Business Committee’s Report to us. We adopted it, of which the

Tuesday was not part of it. Mr Speaker, at Conclave, you were there with me, and we did not have any indication that the Hon Deputy Minister is coming to answer the Questions. We got a different indication from the Hon Majority Leader. He communicated to us at Conclave what happened to the Minister, and that the Minister cannot answer the Question.

We agreed to that with the Speaker, but we cannot say because the Hon Minister is unavailable today, he will be programmed for Tuesday. That is not how it is done. We have Business already programmed for Tuesday, and for that matter, he cannot hijack and say that he should be put on Tuesday. Mr Speaker, of that, it is left with the Business Committee to programme such Questions, not the Hon Majority Chief Whip.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my Brother Habib Iddrisu should calm down. All we are saying is that we ought to have taken nine Questions and four Statements today. But given the exigencies of the House, we are unable to. Today is Friday, and the Hon Minister has detailed his able Deputy, who is capable to respond to the Questions. But it is the sense of the House that we cannot take those Answers. So, it is the practice—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, while you were on this Side, we were offloading Business to— *[Interruption]*. We were

doing that. Mr Speaker, all I am saying is that, if he will not oppose the request, then we should push today's Questions and Statements to Tuesday, to be accommodated alongside Business slated for Tuesday. That is all I am saying.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we can continue this way. It is almost 8 o'clock. The indication that we are ready to do Business, I do not believe it to be true that we are ready to do Business.

Hon Majority Chief Whip, you may do the needful.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, there being no further Business to be conducted, I move that this House be adjourned until Tuesday at 2:00 p.m. I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion is moved for adjournment, and it is for the consideration of the House.

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, we are not opposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 7:43 p.m. till Tuesday, 11th November, 2025 at 2:00 p.m.

LIST OF REFERRALS PENDING AT COMMITTEES

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
1.	Finance Committee (10 Referrals)	1. Annual Report on the Petroleum Funds for the 2024 Fiscal Year 2. Annual Report on the Management of the Energy Sector Levies and Accounts for the Year 2024 3. Annual Public Debt Management Report for the 2024 Financial Year 4. Budget Performance Report in Respect of the Ministry of Finance for the Period January to December, 2024 5. Report of the Finance Committee on the Ghana Cocoa Board (Amendment) Bill, 2025 6. Ghana Deposit Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2025 7. Annual Report on Public Private Partnership Projects for the year 2024. 8. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Securities and Exchange Commission for the year 2024. 9. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Public Interest and Accountability Committee (PIAC) for the year 2024. 10. Annual Report of the Public Interest and Accountability Committee (PIAC) on the Management and Use of Petroleum Revenues for the Period January – December 2024.
2.	Public Accounts Committee (17 Referrals)	1. Follow-up Report of the Auditor-General on the Three Performance Audits in respect of: Regulating Small-Scale Mining for a Sustainable Environment; Sustainability of Sports Stadia in Ghana; and Administration of Scholarships by the GETFund 2. Report of the Auditor-General on the Statements of Foreign Exchange Receipts and Payments of the Bank of Ghana (BoG) for the Half-Year Ended 30th June 2024 3. Special Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the recoveries made from disallowed expenditure in the Auditor-General's Reports from 2020 to 2023 and payroll savings as at 31st December 2024 4. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana: Public Boards, Corporations

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		and other Statutory Institutions for the Period Ended 31st December, 2024 5. Report of the Auditor-General on the Accounts of District Assemblies for the Financial Year ended 31st December 2024 6. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Availability of Fertilisers to Small Holder Farmers in Ghana 7. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Provision and Maintenance of Toilet Facilities in Public Schools 8. Report of the Auditor-General on the Management and Utilisation of the District Assemblies' Common Fund (DACF) and Other Statutory Funds for the year ended 31st December, 2024 9. Report of the Auditor-General on the Management of Petroleum Funds for the Period January to December 2024 10. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana – Public Universities and Colleges of Education for the Year Ended 31st December 2024 11. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana - Ministries, Departments and Other Agencies for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024 12. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Utilisation of GNPC's Share of the Petroleum Revenue on Infrastructure Projects 13. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on Computerised Financial and Electronic Systems in Selected Covered Entities as at 31st December, 2024 14. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Procurement and Management of Medical Equipment in Teaching Hospitals 15. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana (Whole-of-Government Accounts) for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024 16. Report of the Auditor-General on the Consolidated Statements of Foreign Exchange Receipts and Payments of the Bank of Ghana (BoG) for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		17. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana, Pre-University Educational Institutions for the Financial Year Ended 31st December 2024.
3.	Committee on Local Government and Rural Development (81 Referrals)	1. Annual report of the District Assemblies Common Fund for the year 2023 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Births and Deaths Registry for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jaman North District Assembly for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi Nchumuru District Assembly for the year 2024. 7. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atiwa West District Assembly for the year 2024. 8. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tema West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 9. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mampong Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 10. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jasikan Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 11. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Juaboso District Assembly for the year 2024. 12. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the La Nkwantanang-Madina Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 13. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Berekum Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 14. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga Central Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 15. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tano North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 16. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Local Government, Decentralisation and Rural Development for the year 2024. 17. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 18. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mion District Assembly for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		19. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kadjebi District Assembly for the year 2024. 20. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ningo-Prampram District Assembly for the year 2024. 21. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Pru West District Assembly for the year 2024. 22. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jaman South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 23. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ledzokuku Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 24. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu-Amantin Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 25. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tema Metropolitan Assembly for the year 2024. 26. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu-Amantin Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 27. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Biakoye District Assembly for the year 2024. 28. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Fanteakwa North District Assembly for the year 2024. 29. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the New Juaben North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 30. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Yilo Krobo Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 31. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tatale-Sanguli District Assembly for the year 2024. 32. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sunyani West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 33. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Gushegu Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 34. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nanton District Assembly for the year 2024. 35. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ayawaso North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 36. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Abuakwa North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		37. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ablekuma North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 38. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bosomtwe District Assembly for the year 2024. 39. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Guan District Assembly for the year 2024. 40. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nsawam/Adoagyiri Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 41. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ahanta West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 42. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Hohoe Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 43. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tolon District Assembly for the year 2024. 44. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bekwai Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 45. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kintampo South District Assembly for the year 2024. 46. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 47. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ashanti Regional Co-ordinating Council for the year 2024. 48. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Afigya Kwabre South District Assembly for the year 2024. 49. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Afigya Kwabre North District Assembly for the year 2024. 50. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sefwi Akontombra District Assembly for the year 2024. 51. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ablekuma North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 52. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Okere District Assembly for the year 2024. 53. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Shama District Assembly for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		54. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Amansie Central District Assembly for the year 2024. 55. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Amansie South District Assembly for the year 2024. 56. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kwadaso Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 57. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asunafo North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 58. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Adansi North District Assembly for the year 2024. 59. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nkoranza North District Assembly for the year 2024. 60. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Old Tafo Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 61. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Agona West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 62. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tano South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 63. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sekyere East District Assembly for the year 2024. 64. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Lower Manya Krobo Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 65. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Birim North District Assembly for the year 2024. 66. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ayawaso East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 67. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Keta Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 68. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akuapem North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024 69. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akuapim South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024 70. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atiwa East District Assembly for the year 2024. 71. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Amansie West District Assembly for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		72. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atwima Nwabiagya North District Assembly for the year 2024 73. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akim North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024 74. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cape Coast Metropolitan Assembly for the year 2024 75. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ablekuma Central Municipal Assembly for the year 2024 76. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kwahu West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024 77. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asene Manso Akroso District Assembly for the year 2024 78. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Korle-Klottey Municipal Assembly for the year 2024 79. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sagnarigu Municipal Assembly for the year 2024 80. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Gomaa West District Assembly for the year 2024 81. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akrofuom District Assembly for the year 2024
4.	Committee on Public Administration and State Interests (9 Referrals)	1. Annual Report on the Staffing Position of the Office of the President for the Period 1st January to 31st December 2024. 2. Budget Performance Report in respect of Office of the Head of the Civil Service for the Period January to December, 2024 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Office of the President for the year 2024 4. Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Office of the Head of Civil Service for the year 2024. 6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Office of the President for the year 2024 7. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the State Interests and Governance Authority for the year 2024. 8. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Identification Authority for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		9. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Identification Authority for the year 2024.
5.	Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies (5 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in Respect of the Audit Service for the Period January to December, 2024 2. Budget Performance Report in Respect of the National Commission for Civic Education for the Period January to December, 2024 3. Budget Performance Report in respect of Office of the Electoral Commission for the Period January to December, 2024 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Commission for Civic Education for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice (CHRAJ) for the year 2024.
6.	Committee on Lands and Natural Resources (7 Referrals)	1. Annual Report of the Forestry Commission for the Year 2022 2. Budget Performance Report in Respect of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources for the Period January to December, 2024 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Land Use and Spatial Planning Authority (LUSPA) for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Minerals Commission for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Office of the Administrator of Stool Lands for the year 2024. 6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Forestry Commission for the year 2023. 7. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Forestry Commission for the year 2024.
7.	Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs (6 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice for the Period January to December, 2024 2. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Office of the Special Prosecutor for the Period January to December, 2024 3. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Legal Aid Commission for the Period January to December, 2024

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Architectural and Engineering Services Limited for the year 2024 5. Annual Report of the Right to Information Commission for the year 2024. 6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana School of Law for the year 2024
8.	Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs (2 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture Development for the Period January to December, 2024 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Irrigation Development Authority for the year 2024.
9.	Committee on Youth and Sports (2 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Youth and Sports for the Period January to December, 2024 2. Report on the 13th African Games, Accra 2023, hosted by Ghana from 3rd - 23rd March, 2024
10.	Committee on Works and Housing (5 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Works and Housing for the Period January to December, 2024 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the State Housing Company for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the TDC Ghana Limited for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources for the year 2024.
11.	Committee on Roads and Transportation (6 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Transport for the Period January to December, 2024 2. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Railway Development for the Period January to December, 2024 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Volta Lake Transport Company Limited for the year 2024 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Road Safety Authority for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Shippers' Authority for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Maritime Authority for the year 2024
12.	Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism (4 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Trade and Industry for the Period January to December, 2024 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the year 2024 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Tourism Authority for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Export Promotion Authority for the year 2024.
13.	Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions (1 Referral)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Employment and Labour Relations for the Period January to December, 2024
14.	Committee on Education (82 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Presbyterian College of Education, Akropong-Akuapem for the year 2024 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Communication Technology University for the year 2024 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nusrat Jahan Ahmadiyya College of Education for the year 2024 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mount Mary College of Education, Somanya, for the year 2024 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) for the year 2024 6. University for Development Studies Bill, 2025 7. Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025 8. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Koforidua Technical University for the year 2024. 9. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the OLA College of Education, Cape Coast, for the year 2024. 10. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Accra Technical University for the year 2024. 11. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kumasi Technical University for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		12. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ada College of Education for the year 2024. 13. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Presbyterian Women's College of Education, Aburi, for the year 2024. 14. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Complementary Education Agency for the year 2024. 15. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Education, Winneba, for the year 2024. 16. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu College of Education for the year 2024. 17. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University for Development Studies for the year 2024. 18. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Chartered Institute of Bankers, Ghana for the year 2024. 19. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the McCoy College of Education for the year 2024. 20. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Enchi College of Education for the year 2024. 21. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the SDA College of Education, Asokore, Koforidua for the year 2024. 22. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the E.P. College of Education, Bimbilla for the year 2024. 23. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Abetifi Presbyterian College of Education for the year 2024. 24. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Media Arts and Communication for the year 2024. 25. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Wiawso College of Education for the year 2024. 26. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Louis College of Education for the year 2024. 27. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Komenda College of Education for the year 2024. 28. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Schools Inspectorate Authority for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		29. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akrokerri College of Education for the year 2024. 30. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Takoradi Technical University for the year 2024. 31. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Science Association for the year 2024. 32. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ho Technical University for the year 2024. 33. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Peki College of Education for the year 2024. 34. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Health and Allied Sciences for the year 2024. 35. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St Francis College of Education for the year 2024. 36. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Mines and Technology for the year 2024. 37. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mampong Technical College of Education for the year 2024. 38. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Students Loan Trust Fund for the year 2024. 39. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Wesley College of Education for the year 2024. 40. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sunyani Technical University for the year 2024. 41. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tumu College of Education for the year 2024. 42. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Joseph College of Education for the year 2024. 43. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Berekum College of Education for the year 2024. 44. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Monica College of Education for the year 2024. 45. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Gbewaa College of Education for the year 2024. 46. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Energy and Natural Resources for the year 2024. 47. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Cape Coast for the year 2024. 48. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Evangelical Presbyterian College of Education, Amedzofe for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		49. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Institute of Chartered Accountants Ghana for the year 2024. 50. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jasikan College of Education for the year 2024. 51. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Vincent College of Education for the year 2024. 52. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akatsi College of Education for the year 2024. 53. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Ambrose College of Education for the year 2024. 54. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cape Coast Technical University for the year 2024. 55. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Professional Studies, Accra for the year 2024. 56. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Library Authority for the year 2024. 57. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Academy of Arts and Sciences for the year 2024. 58. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Simon Diedong Dombo University of Business and Integrated Development Studies for the year 2024. 59. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Teresa's College of Education for the year 2024. 60. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Al-Faruq College of Education for the year 2024. 61. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tamale Technical University for the year 2024. 62. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. John Bosco's College of Education, Navrongo for the year 2024 63. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Wesley College of Education for the year 2024. 64. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sunyani Technical University for the year 2024. 65. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tumu College of Education for the year 2024. 66. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Joseph College of Education for the year 2024. 67. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Berekum College of Education for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		68. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Monica College of Education for the year 2024. 69. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Gbewaa College of Education for the year 2024. 70. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Energy and Natural Resources for the year 2024. 71. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Cape Coast for the year 2024. 72. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Evangelical Presbyterian College of Education, Amedzofe for the year 2024. 73. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Institute of Chartered Accountants Ghana for the year 2024. 74. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jasikan College of Education for the year 2024. 75. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Vincent College of Education for the year 2024. 76. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akatsi College of Education for the year 2024. 77. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Ambrose College of Education for the year 2024. 78. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cape Coast Technical University for the year 2024. 79. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Professional Studies, Accra for the year 2024. 80. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Library Authority for the year 2024. 81. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Academy of Arts and Sciences for the year 2024. 82. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Simon Diedong Dombo University of Business and Integrated Development Studies for the year 2024.
15.	Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare (2 Referral)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Department of Social Welfare for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
16.	Committee on Subsidiary Legislation (4 Referrals)	1. Fees and Charges (Miscellaneous Provisions) (Amendment) Regulations, 2025. 2. Revenue Administration Regulations, 2025. 3. Judicial Service (Terms and Conditions of Service) Regulations, 2025. 4. Exemptions Regulations 2025.
17.	Committee on Health (22 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Ghana Medical Centre for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Food and Drug Authority for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of Nurses' Training College, Pantang for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Centre for Plant Medicine Research for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mental Health Authority for the year 2024. 6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana AIDS Commission for the year 2024. 7. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the College of Community Health Nursing, Winneba for the year 2024. 8. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Yilo Krobo Municipal Health Directorate for the year 2024. 9. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Yilo Krobo District Hospital for the year 2024. 10. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Somanaya Polyclinic for the year 2024. 11. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Health Facilities Regulatory Authority for the year 2024. 12. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Medical and Dental Council for the year 2024. 13. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Cardiothoracic Centre for the year 2024. 14. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the College of Nursing and Midwifery, Nalerigu for the year 2024. 15. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the College of Community Health Nursing, Winneba for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		16. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Yilo Krobo Municipal Health Directorate for the year 2024. 17. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Yilo Krobo District Hospital for the year 2024. 18. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Somanya Polyclinic for the year 2024. 19. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Health Facilities Regulatory Authority for the year 2024. 20. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Medical and Dental Council for the year 2024. 21. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Cardiothoracic Centre for the year 2024. 22. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the College of Nursing and Midwifery, Nalerigu for the year 2024.
18.	Committee on Energy (9 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Petroleum Authority for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Volta River Authority for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bui Power Authority for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Petroleum Hub Development Corporation for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Grid Company Limited for the year 2024. 6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Northern Electricity Distribution Company for the year 2024. 7. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Electricity Company of Ghana for the year 2024. 8. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana National Gas Company for the year 2024. 9. Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco) and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 1 (GH_WB_01).

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
19.	Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs (1 Referral)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Theatre of Ghana for the year 2024.
20.	Committee on Defence and Interior (3 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana National Fire Service for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Prisons Service for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Gaming Commission of Ghana for the year 2024.
21.	Committee on Economy and Development (2 Referrals)	1. 2024 Annual National Progress Report of the National Development Planning Commission on the Implementation of the Medium-Term National Development Plan Under the Policy Framework (An Agenda for Jobs II: Creating Prosperity and Equal Opportunity for All - 2022-2025). 2. Report of the National Population Council Secretariat on the Fifty-Eighth Session of the Commission on Population and Development (CPD) held in April 2025 in New York.
22.	Committee on Environment, Science and Technology (3 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Atomic Energy Commission for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Environmental Protection Authority for the year 2024.
23.	Committee on Information and Communications (5 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Information Technology Authority for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Data Protection Commission for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cyber Security Authority for the year 2024. 4. Annual Report on the Implementation of the Right to Information Act, 2019 (Act 989) for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Geological Survey Authority for the year 2024.

